Odia Cinema

A Living Screen

Stories, People and the Places Between



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About this edition

Odia Cinema: A Living Screen

Stories, People and the Places Between

By Ahimanikya Satapathy

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Numbered citations lead to chapter-grouped source notes at the end of the book. Each note links back to its first cited passage. Further-reading links to chapters stay within this PDF; other references open their source pages.

Before the first frame

A film can begin in a familiar household and lead us towards questions we had not thought to ask. Who makes the decisions? Whose work remains outside the frame? How does a story find its viewers, and what allows it to survive for generations?

This book follows those questions through selected films, careers and institutions connected with Odisha. Its chapters move between literature and performance, artistic choices and working lives, recognition and access. They invite readers to notice a composer beside a director, a production team beside a performer, and the people represented by a story beside the person telling it.

The selection is an invitation to explore further. Published credits, archives, interviews and criticism provide its foundations; where their evidence differs or remains incomplete, the distinction matters. A remembered success, a festival selection and a recorded award each tell a different story.

Read these chapters in sequence or follow a curiosity. Return to the works, compare accounts, and look for the names that deserve another conversation. A living screen leaves room for the next viewer to ask something new.

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PART 1 · BEGINNINGS AND SHARED VOICES

01 Odia cinema: the world in our own voice



AI-generated editorial illustration using Human Natural Editorial mode; not a film still and not a record of a particular restoration or institution.

On 27 June 2024, ମାୟା ମିରିଗ *(Maya Miriga)* returned to a screen in Bologna, restored after its negative was found badly damaged.[1]

There is something unsettling about that journey. A film can travel across the world, enter festival history, and still come close to disappearing.

Nirad Mohapatra's film asks what family gives its members - and what it withholds. His programme note holds warmth alongside daughters-in-law's desire for freedom.[1]

The restored film's Bologna screening brings this household story into the history of how Odia films circulate and survive.

This account follows selected connections between performance, literature, filmmaking and audiences. Surviving credits, archives and published testimony shape the examples available here; they do not define a complete canon. The companion essays follow particular films and people in more detail.

Before the camera: Natak, Rasa and Gitinatya

Sita Bibah had a life before the camera. A later report by Minati Singha identifies a play by Kamapal Mishra as the basis of *Sita Bibah*.[2] Piyush Roy's research describes Goswami's touring rasalila group and his work training performers. In an interview recorded by Roy, film historian Surya Deo characterises the first film as primarily *gitinatya*, or musical drama.[3]

This gives the connection a human shape. Goswami brought experience of performing, singing and organising a troupe to filmmaking. A familiar story could now be carried by recorded voices and moving images. The stage connection lies in particular people and a dramatic text, as well as in the place of song within the film.

Gitinatya joins dramatic storytelling with music and verse. Theatre scholar Alok Baral places Kalicharan Pattanaik among its practitioners.[4] Kalicharan also wrote lyrics for *Lalita*, according to Bhuyan's retrospective.[5] His work connects musical theatre with the second Odia feature through an identifiable contribution.

The wider performance world deserves its own attention. Our guides to Prahallad Nataka, Pala, Daskathia and Odisha's theatre traditions explore different ways of singing, narrating and enacting a story. They provide context for thinking about cinema's neighbours. A direct production link from each of these forms to *Sita Bibah* has not been

established; the evidence is stronger for Goswami's own Rasa and theatre background.

The first Odia film: Sita Bibah, 1936

Odia cinema's first feature was ସୀତା ବିବାହ *(Sita Bibah)*, made by Mohan Sundar Deb Goswami. Film writer Kapilas Bhuyan's IFFI retrospective records its formal opening in Puri on **28 April 1936**, after a Calcutta screening the previous month. The next Odia feature, ଲଳିତା *(Lalita)*, arrived in **1949**.[5]

Thirteen years is a striking interval. A first film establishes possibility; it does not by itself establish a continuing industry. The familiar anniversary date deserves to be remembered alongside the difficulty of making the next film.

Music was present from the beginning. Bhuyan records fourteen songs in *Sita Bibah*, sung by its actors, and a move to background singing in *Lalita*. Later films drew on Odia literature, including ଅମଡ଼ା ବାଟ *(Amada Bata)*, ମଲାଜହ୍ନ *(Malajanha)* and ମାଟିର ମଣିଷ *(Matira Manisha)*.[5]

The screen offered another life to words and voices already circulating through the culture. To understand that foundation, we need to follow writers and composers as closely as directors. A film's opening credits can be a small map of the arts meeting one another.

Radio drama: another home for the storyteller

Radio enters this account later. AIR Cuttack began in **1948**, twelve years after the first Odia feature. The Odia Bibhaba archive records Gopal Chhotray's association with the station from its beginning.[6] Its writers joined a film culture already underway.

Chhotray is a concrete link between the media. The Library of Congress documents his work in Gitinatya, his long association with AIR Cuttack, and his writing of plays, operas and screenplays.[7] The Gour-Parbati

archive credits him specifically with **dialogue for* ଶ୍ରୀଜଗନ୍ନାଥ (Sri Jagannath) *(1950)**, while assigning direction and screenplay to C.R. Mitra.[8]

His career helps us follow the writer between a stage, a microphone and a film production. Radio drama asks listeners to imagine a scene through voices and sound; cinema supplies moving images as well. Chhotray's credited dialogue supplies one specific connection between those working worlds.

Continue this history: ଆକାଶବାଣୀ କଟକ - AIR Cuttack: where stories found another voice.

The people who built more than a screen career

Parbati Ghose belongs near the centre of this history. The Gour-Parbati filmography records her as a co-producer with Gour Prasad Ghose on ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ *(Laxmi)*, କା *(Kaa)* and ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ *(Stree)*. It also credits her within the directing partnership used on *Kaa* and *Stree*. Her work crossed the boundaries between performing, organising a production and deciding what would reach the screen.[9]

The archive dates her ଛ'ମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ *(Chha Mana Atha Guntha)* adaptation to 1986. Its credits name **Nagen Barik** for sound and **Asim Basu and Sarat Sahoo** for art, and acknowledge Olosingh's villagers and host **Kalyani Patnaik**.[10] The Parbati Ghose companion follows her producing, writing, directing and acting work.

The places and teams that sustain production

Institutions mattered too. The Odisha Film Development Corporation was incorporated on **22 April 1976**. Its stated remit included support for film production, cinema houses, studio services and film culture. These are the less visible foundations: access to equipment, places to finish a film, and places where audiences can watch it.[11]

The *Chha Mana Atha Guntha* archive names **Kalinga Studio** and **Prasad Film Laboratory** among its credits, while stating that the shoot took place entirely in Olosingh. The credits do not specify which services those facilities supplied.[10]

Private facilities form another part of this infrastructure. India Cine Hub lists Mute Entertainment's Mute Studio in Bhubaneswar under post-production companies, advertising editing, visual effects and chroma services.[12]

Technology also appears in performers' memories. Uttam Mohanty contrasted reflector-lit shoots earlier in his career with later low-light work, in a 2018 interview.[13]

Public infrastructure has its own chain of responsibility. **Naveen Patnaik** laid the rebuilding foundation stone for Kalinga Studio on **25 March 2021**; the Industries Department assigned implementation to **IDCO** and existing-building renovation to the **R&B Department**.[14] **Mohan Charan Majhi** inaugurated the redeveloped studio and its cinema archive and museum on **5 October 2026**. The recorded events concern redevelopment; they do not establish its commercial outcomes.[15]

A film culture needs places to learn and people willing to organise a screening. **Nirad Mohapatra's** memorial biography records his teaching at FTII and his work with **Cinexstasy**, a Bhubaneswar film society active from 1974 to 1983. Screenings and film-appreciation courses were another part of his contribution, beyond directing *Maya Miriga*.[16]

Maya Miriga and other films in circulation

Maya Miriga received Second Best Feature Film at the 31st National Film Awards, for films of 1983; festival records commonly date it to 1984.[17] In 1984 it was selected for Cannes Critics' Week and shared Mannheim's Grand Prize in the Third World competition, distinct from that festival's overall Grand Prize.[18, 19] The Maya Miriga companion follows both its family story and its restoration.

Manmohan Mahapatra offers another essential route into this period. ଶୀତରାତି *(Seeta Raati)* received the Best Oriya Film honour at the 29th National Film Awards, for the 1981 award year. The festival catalogue for 1985 also records screenings in Paris and Montreal.[20]

In his account of Odisha's New Wave, critic Ashok Palit describes the social worlds of Mahapatra's films: a rural community facing upheaval in ନୀରବ ଝଡ଼ *(Niraba Jhada)*, and a family negotiating social change in ନିଷିଦ୍ଧ ସ୍ୱପ୍ନ *(Nisiddha Swapna)*. His survey places Mahapatra and Nirad Mohapatra among the filmmakers who developed a sustained interest in cinema as an art of close observation.[21]

These films explored households and communities under pressure. National awards and international screenings form another part of their histories; they do not explain by themselves how audiences responded.

Bhukha, and the importance of hearing western Odisha



Sabyasachi Mohapatra at the Odisha State Film Awards, Bhubaneswar, 2014. Photograph: Subhashish Panigrahi; existing crop by MKar, via Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0. No additional crop.

Sabyasachi Mohapatra's ଭୂଖ *(Bhukha)* (**1989**) makes the map of cinema in Odisha more expansive. It is a **Sambalpuri-language film**. Palit reads its conflict through the pressures between inherited ways of life and modernity.[21]

The story grew from a Sambalpuri play by Manglu Charan Biswal. It follows bajnia folk drummers whose livelihoods are threatened by changing musical practices. The stakes are both cultural and material: what happens to the people who carry a tradition when their work is no longer wanted?[22]

Naming the language matters. The cinema of a state can contain several cultural centres, accents and storytelling traditions. Sambalpuri cinema deserves to be heard in its own voice within this larger history.

The official 70th National Film Awards catalogue credits *Bhukha* with an **International Jury Award at Gijón**, Spain. The biography does not specify the year of that prize, so the film's 1989 date should not automatically be attached to the award.[23]

Mohapatra's later work offers further, separately documented milestones. ଶଳାବୁଢ଼ା *(Sala Budha)* was selected for Indian Panorama in 2013. ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର *(Aadim Vichar)* received the Best Odiya Film award at the 62nd National Film Awards, for 2014, announced in 2015.[24, 25]

Scholar Amrit Amlan Pattanaik approaches these Sambalpuri films through western Odisha's cultural and literary worlds, asking how they widen the ways Odisha appears on screen. His study's published abstract offers a valuable starting question for a deeper article: what becomes visible when we stop treating a region as if it has only one centre?[26]

Children, imagination and the screen

Children belong in this history as viewers with imaginative lives of their own. Live-action films made for children, local animation and films offered in an Odia-language version open different routes to those viewers.

Sadhu Meher's ବାବୁଲା (Babula) provides a concrete starting point for the first history. A Lok Sabha answer of 7 December 1987 lists it among the Children's Film Society of India's productions for 1985-86, identifying it as an Oriya feature. A contemporary 1986 catalogue from Berlin's Arsenal describes Meher's CFSI-supported film through a lonely boy's dreams of outer space. This places institutional support and a child's imagination within the same account. [27, 28]

A. K. Bir's ଲାବଣ୍ୟ ପ୍ରୀତି (Lavanya Preeti) offers another firmly documented example. The 41st National Film Awards catalogue names the Oriya film as Best Children's Film for 1993. Its citation recognises the movement from childhood into adolescence through myth and visual storytelling. The accompanying synopsis explains Bir's use of a story within a story to engage children and young people. Here childhood includes curiosity, attachment and growing awareness, rather than merely providing a small character inside an adult plot. [29]

The history of what children can hear in Odia is wider than the history of original Odia production. ରିଟର୍ଣ୍ଣ ଅଫ୍ ହନୁମାନ (Return of Hanuman) demonstrates why records must be read carefully. CBFC's 2022 list records an Odia video version certified on 11 February 2022, naming Shemaroo Entertainment. Airtel Xstream's official catalogue describes the Anurag Kashyap film as a 2007 title available in Odia and places it under animation and children's entertainment. The later certificate records a language version; it should not turn the film into a new Odia production of 2022. The provider listing supplies a route to check availability, not a guarantee of playback in every location. [30, 31]

Actors whose journeys crossed languages

For performers, the path beyond Odisha sometimes ran through films made in other languages.

Sadhu Meher received the National Film Award for Best Actor for his performance in Shyam Benegal's Hindi film ଅଙ୍କୁର *(Ankur)*, honoured at the 22nd awards for 1974. The official catalogue records his upbringing in Odisha and his training at the Film and Television Institute in Pune. This is a major achievement by an actor from Odisha, within the history of Hindi cinema.[32]

Nandita Das carries a different connection. In her own essay about belonging, she recalls her father's Baripada roots and her childhood visits. She was born in Bombay and grew up in Delhi. Her Odisha

relationship is one of family and experience, rather than an Odisha birthplace.[33]

Her connection also includes acting in Odia: she appeared in Susant Misra's ବିଶ୍ୱପ୍ରକାଶ **(Biswaprakash / The Young Rebel, 1999)**, listed in her official filmography. The Nandita Das article explores that credit alongside her wider career.[34]

Cannes records her membership of its feature-film jury in **2005** and its Cinéfondation and short-film jury in **2013**. Her film ମଣ୍ଟୋ *(Manto)* was selected for Un Certain Regard in **2018**. These occasions mark both jury service and film selection across her career in acting and directing.[35]

The home audience must remain in this story too. Akashvani's account of **Uttam Mohanty** records an extensive Odia career alongside work in Bengali cinema and the Hindi film ନୟା ଜହର *(Naya Zahar)*. His example opens another chapter: the relationship between popular actors, recurring collaborators and audiences who return to watch them.[36]

Songs offer another way into that relationship. In her account of composer **Prafulla Kar**, journalist Minati Singha recalls the success of his music for ମମତା *(Mamata)*. A film can continue to live through the songs its listeners carry away; composers and playback singers belong within this history of recognition too.[37]

A festival history and a history of popular affection answer different questions. We need both to understand what a film culture means to the people who sustain it.

New films, familiar pressures: 2022-2025

Recent national recognition provides further starting points. Anupam Patnaik's ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା *(Pratikshya)* received Best Odia Film at the **69th National Film Awards**, announced in 2023 for the 2021 award year. ଦମନ *(Daman)*, directed by Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka, received Best Odia Film at the **70th awards**, announced in 2024 for 2022.[38, 39]



Babushaan Mohanty in 2018, before his starring role in Daman. Event photograph by Jnanaranjan Sahu, via Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0. Original close-up retained uncropped and without AI modification; this is not a film still.

The actors make these recent titles more than entries in an awards list. In *Pratikshya*, **Dipanwit Dashmohapatra** plays Sanjay, a young man seeking a government job while his family faces debt and his father's illness. Inspired by a story by **Gourahari Das**, the film brings literature into a contemporary father-son relationship. At IFFI in November 2022, Dipanwit described it as his first film as a lead actor.[40]

Babushaan Mohanty offers another route into the period through ଦମନ (DAMaN). Our companion article follows the film's making, its fictional doctor and the wider healthcare work behind its subject. These films invite us to follow performers and collaborators as well as prizes: who receives a substantial role, whose writing reaches the screen, and which stories find a larger audience?

The range also includes କର୍ମ **(Karma, 2024)**. Anupam Patnaik directed **Anubhav Mohanty** as investigator Amar Patnaik in a murder-case thriller. The filmmaker behind *Pratikshya* was working with a different star and dramatic form; contemporary Odia cinema cannot be reduced to a single kind of revival.[41]

Recent releases and the work of reaching audiences

A film culture also depends on tickets sold and the chance to finance the next production. In 2025, ବୋଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ **(Bou Buttu Bhuta)** supplied a conspicuous commercial story. Directed by **Jagdish Mishra**, the horror-comedy brought **Aparajita Mohanty, Babushaan Mohanty and Archita Sahu** together in leading roles. On 24 September 2025, *The New Indian Express* reported box-office revenue of nearly **₹21 crore**, against a reported budget of **₹2-3 crore**. These are reported figures, not audited accounts or a calculation of producer profit.[42]

The same report described Dharma Productions as being **in the process of acquiring remake rights**. That was a commercial development reported at the time, not evidence of a completed remake. It suggests another way an Odia story can travel: through interest in adapting it for other audiences.[42]

Commercial momentum has a setting as well as a number. During Raja in June 2025, *The New Indian Express* reported packed shows for *Bou Buttu Bhuta* and ଅନନ୍ତ **(Ananta)**. The latter starred **Sabyasachi Mishra** and was directed by **Sabyasachi Mohapatra**, drawing on

Fakir Mohan Senapati's *Randi Pua Ananta*. Literature and popular exhibition were meeting again.[43]

Yet distributor **Prashant B**, quoted in that report, said a shortage of cinema halls left some areas unreached. The point matters: a successful run in available theatres does not mean everyone has access to the film. The commercial story includes the work of exhibitors and distributors, ticket affordability, and the distance between a willing viewer and a screen.[43]

These recent films extend several parts of the history at once: literary adaptation, substantial acting roles, genre entertainment and the search for a sustainable audience. A national award, a busy screening and a remake negotiation each tell us something different. Taken together, they give a fuller picture of the work still being made.

Audiences and income beyond Odisha

There is evidence of commercial exhibition outside the state. *The New Indian Express* reported on 13 November 2022 that *DAMaN* had opened on 4 November in **51 theatres in Odisha and 15 theatres across nine other cities**: Bengaluru, Chennai, Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Ahmedabad, Surat, Pune and Hyderabad. The report described packed houses, but supplied no separate receipts for those markets.[44]

Overseas announcements show another route to audiences. On 26 April 2023, *OrissaPOST* reported plans to screen ଫାଲ୍ଗୁନ ଚୈତ୍ର **(Phalguna Chaitra)** on 13 May at Hoyts Docklands in Melbourne, Hoyts Blacktown in Sydney and Event Cinemas in Brisbane. A July follow-up in *OrissaPOST* subsequently reported overseas screenings, including Australia. Neither report supplied receipts or a country-by-country earnings breakdown.[45, 46]

Streaming can reach viewers who have no nearby Odia screening. In Lata Jha's April 2025 report for *Mint*, **Kaushik Das**, founder of Odia

platform **AAO NXT**, described overseas viewers seeking stories that reconnect them with home. [47]

Paid screenings, streaming and rights agreements can provide income, but these sources do not establish the share of Odia cinema's earnings from outside the state or overseas. The OTT companion follows the platform and audience questions further.

The story continues on television and online

Cinema is one part of a wider screen culture. Odia television created another rhythm of storytelling through recurring programmes and serials. Prasar Bharati dates the Odia satellite service to 1993 and its round-the-clock broadcasting to 2001.[48]

Streaming added further routes. Tarang Plus's 2019 launch offering combined television channels, films, jatra and original web content. An inherited catalogue and a newly commissioned series could now reach viewers through the same service, although they remained different kinds of production.[49]

The Odia television history follows public broadcasting, private channels, performers and production workers. The Odia OTT journey examines original storytelling, platform economics and audiences beyond Odisha. Together with AIR Cuttack, these histories show how stories can move between forms without every new medium displacing its predecessors.

Keeping the next chapter within reach

The Bologna screening at the beginning of this story adds another question to this contemporary energy. What can another generation actually see?

Preservation depends on teams too. **Shivendra Singh Dungarpur** describes Film Heritage Foundation's conservators repairing *Maya*

Miriga. Its restoration credits also name **L'Immagine Ritrovata, Digital Film Restore and Prasad Corporation**, in association with the filmmaker's family, and identify NFDC-NFAI's surviving print. A restored image carries technical labour that a director's name alone cannot acknowledge.[50]

The research register of storytelling contributors follows additional work in broadcasting, production and community support. It records what each person or team did and where the evidence stops. Giving credit should recover the work, not replace one star-centred history with a new list of famous names.

The next chapter of Odia cinema history belongs partly to viewers: watching beyond the famous titles, learning the names behind the credits, asking for subtitled and restored editions, and making room for films whose worlds are unfamiliar even within Odisha.

For a viewing journey, one starting point is the household in *Maya Miriga*, followed by the livelihoods in *Bhukha* and today's family dramas, thrillers and popular releases. These are invitations to explore the films; the reading sequence continues next with AIR Cuttack. Which film would you want the next generation to be able to find?

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Full-film listing:** ଦମନ **(DAMaN) on Amara Muzik Odia's YouTube channel.** Verified official-channel page; playback untested.

- **Official trailer:** ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା **(Pratikshya).** Amiya Patnaik Productions.

- **Official trailer:** କର୍ମ **(Karma).** Amara Muzik Odia.

- **Official trailer:** ବୋଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ **(Bou Buttu Bhuta).** Sidharth Music.

- **Official trailer:** ଅନନ୍ତ **(Ananta).** Amara Muzik Odia.

- **Restoration clip and information:** ମାୟା ମିରିଗ **(Maya Miriga).** Film Heritage Foundation's restoration page and comparison clip, not the full film.

- **Provider catalogue, Odia version:** ରିଟର୍ଣ୍ଣ ଅଫ୍ ହନୁମାନ (Return of Hanuman). Check current access and subscription terms; playback unverified.

The overview follows stories through several working worlds. We pause first at the microphone, where AIR Cuttack opens another way to consider writers, performers, technical work and the imaginative participation of an audience.

PART 1 · BEGINNINGS AND SHARED VOICES

02 ଆକାଶବାଣୀ କଟକ | AIR Cuttack: where stories found another voice



AI-generated editorial illustration for this article; not a film still, documentary photograph or historical studio reconstruction.

A radio play gives the listener no stage to look at. A voice must establish who has entered; a pause can change the meaning of a reply. Music can carry a transition that a film might show through an image. The listener supplies a room, a face, a distance. This makes radio an art of collaboration between people making sound and people imagining what it means.

AIR Cuttack belongs within the history of Odia storytelling for that reason. Its importance reaches beyond the installation of a transmitter.

It offered another place for writers, actors and musicians to work, and another form in which a story could meet its audience.

1948: a new institution in a city of stories

All India Radio's Cuttack station opened in **1948**. The district administration's history places its early establishment in the old Madhupur building.[1] Radio enthusiast Jose Jacob's account of an engineer-guided visit dates the inauguration to **28 January 1948** and describes the initial arrangement of temporary studios and a small transmitter at Killa Fort.[2]

ସୀତା ବିବାହ **(Sita Bibah)** appeared in 1936, before AIR Cuttack. The cinema history follows its earlier stage connections.[3]

What followed was an overlapping history. A writer could work for theatre and broadcasting, then contribute dialogue to a film. A literary work could become a musical play. These movements are more revealing than a simple sequence in which one medium replaces another.



All India Radio, Cuttack, photographed on 27 March 2013. Photograph: Kamalakanta777, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 3.0. Original photograph retained uncropped, including its strong colour cast. This later building view does not show the 1948 opening.

Gopal Chhotray: the writer between the media

Gopal Chhotray offers a particularly clear route through this history. The Library of Congress records his long association with AIR Cuttack and his writing of plays, operas and screenplays. It also recognises his work in the revival of Gitinatya, the verse-based musical-play tradition.[4]

His connection with cinema can be made precise. The Gour-Parbati film archive credits him with dialogue for ଶ୍ରୀଜଗନ୍ନାଥ **(Sri Jagannath, 1950)**. The same record names C.R. Mitra for direction and screenplay.[5]

For a dramatist, dialogue is more than information. It must reveal a relationship, sustain an exchange and give an actor something to do

with a line. The same writer's presence in different media gives us a way to investigate how those skills travelled.

A short story becomes a musical play

Odia Bibhaba's Chhotray collection identifies ଶ୍ରୀମତୀ ସମାର୍ଜନୀ **(Srimati Samarjani)** as an opera adapted from Fakir Mohan Senapati's short story *Patent Medicine*. The collection also brings together stage plays, one-act plays, Gitinatya and unpublished manuscripts. Its catalogue lists a 1974 edition of *Srimati Samarjani*; that is an edition date, not evidence of the first broadcast.[6]

This is one of the most useful connections to follow: a named literary work, an adapter, and a different dramatic form. Adaptation changes the storyteller's tools. Prose can describe a thought directly; a musical play can distribute meaning between spoken exchange, singing and a performer's delivery. Investigating that change requires attention to the particular text and production, rather than treating "folk", "literary" and "popular" as sealed categories.

Our theatre guide provides a wider route into these forms. Pala, Daskathia and Prahallad Nataka have their own performance arrangements and histories. Their presence in Odisha's cultural life should invite comparison, without making every tradition a documented source of every radio programme.

From stage response to studio recording

Lyricist Devdas Chhotray gives a performer's view of the difference. In an interview conducted by Shyamanuja Das in 2018, he contrasts studio singing with a stage performance shaped by immediate audience response. Devdas recalls that his first recorded ghazal was composed and sung by Akshaya Mohanty for AIR Cuttack, and explains that such songs were placed under the programme category *adhunika*.[7]

That recollection makes the institution visible as a working environment: a lyricist, a composer-singer, a recording and a programming category.

A stage performer can notice a response and extend a phrase. A recording fixes a particular performance for another listening situation. Neither is automatically more authentic. The difference helps explain why the same song or dramatic passage can acquire another rhythm when it moves between media.

Who had the opportunity to be heard?

The history also needs the experiences of women performers. In an interview with David Dennen and Amir Kumar Jeetendra Nayak, Shyamamani Devi recalled opposition from relatives to a girl singing publicly, alongside encouragement within her family. She remembered becoming an Akashvani child artist in 1950; the cited recollection does not identify a station, so it belongs here as a wider broadcasting connection.[8]

Her account gives a personal scale to the question of opportunity. An institution's existence and a performer's ability to enter it are different things. Her recollection should not be made to stand for every woman's experience; it does make room for the negotiations and determination that a chronology of buildings and equipment can miss.

Making room for musicians

Programme leadership could help creative work find a home. In a 2020 retrospective, **Shyamanuja Das** credits station director **P.V. Krishnamoorthy** with encouraging lighter music and convening informal exchanges among musicians and lyricists at AIR Cuttack. Das draws on published recollections and artists' accounts. The contribution was to make space for collaboration; the singers, composers and writers remained its creators.[9]

The work behind the voice

Jacob's 2008 visit account describes specialised rooms in the studio complex opened in 1977: spaces for talks, drama, music, dubbing and playback. He observed computers alongside reel-to-reel tapes. His account also recalls transmission disruption during the 1999 cyclone and the effort to restore service.[2]

These are dated observations, but they help recover a less visible part of cultural history. A broadcast depends on technical work as well as a script or singer. Recording, editing, scheduling and transmission determine whether a performance can reach a listener at all. Preserving that history means remembering engineers and programme staff alongside the names printed on books and records.

Listening now, preserving what remains

AIR Cuttack is not only a remembered institution. Akashvani's official Cuttack page provides dated Odia news bulletins online.[10] That establishes a continuing news presence; it does not tell us that every historical programme survives, or how audiences compare across generations.

There are several ways to explore the older work. Odia Bibhaba offers digitised texts; the Library of Congress provides Chhotray's readings from works including *Pheria* and *Parakalama*.[6, 4] Those literary recordings should not be mistaken for original AIR productions. A script, an author reading and a full broadcast preserve different aspects of a work.

A practical next step is to follow one credited writer between a digitised text and an available author reading. The resources preserve different kinds of performance; they do not promise a matching original broadcast. That distinction makes the surviving material useful without asking it to stand for everything once heard on air.

Watch and explore

These exploration pages were checked in the retained research on 25 October 2026. Audio playback was not tested.

- **Literary audio catalogue: Gopal Chhotray at the Library of Congress.** Author readings, not original AIR drama broadcasts.

- **News audio listings: Akashvani Cuttack bulletins.** Browse dated bulletins; not a complete historical radio archive.

The microphone holds no visible audience. Yet the work behind it reaches towards someone listening elsewhere. That distance is part of radio's intimacy: a public voice arriving in a private room.

A voice can begin on a page before it reaches a microphone or a screen. We turn now to the literary worlds that invite another kind of listening.

PART 1 · BEGINNINGS AND SHARED VOICES

03 The page behind the screen

A page can hold a voice before a camera finds a face for it. In Odisha's storytelling, the journey from writing to performance is often a change of company: a narrator gives way to actors, musicians, technicians and an audience. The words do not travel alone.

Reading the place we live in

In the chapter "Bhagia and Saria" of ଛମାଣ ଆଠଗୁଣ୍ଠ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha), Fakir Mohan Senapati's narrator turns towards educated readers who know distant societies better than their neighbours. The question is deliberately ironic:

"ଆପଣାର ବା ପ୍ରତିବାସୀ ଜାତି ଓ ସମାଜର କଥା ଜାଣିବାର ଦରକାର କ'ଣ ?"

"What need is there to know about our own community and society, or our neighbours'?"

English rendering for this edition. The narrator's apparent dismissal is a rebuke to that indifference.[1]

The passage offers Project Odisha a useful question about its own work. What do we learn to notice when we look closely at a place? A history of cinema can follow famous careers and prizes while also attending to the labour, speech and unequal relationships that stories make visible. Knowing a region is not the same as praising everything within it.

Parbati Ghose's chapter follows the adaptation's credited makers. Reading the novel beside the film invites questions rather than a verdict of fidelity. What can an actor convey without the narrator's explanation? Where might a pause, a gesture or a cut carry the work of a sentence? These are invitations to comparison, not descriptions of scenes we have established from the film.

Before the screen, an act of listening

In the opening household passage of ରେବତୀ (Rebati), Fakir Mohan describes a child beside her father as he reads and sings:

“ରେବତୀ ପାଖରେ ବସି ଶୁଣୁଥାଏ|”

“Rebati would sit beside him and listen.”

English rendering for this edition.[2]

This short passage makes listening part of a child’s learning. It belongs to a literary household, not a record of a particular film production. Read alongside the AIR Cuttack chapter, it invites us to consider different settings in which a voice gathers listeners: beside a family member, around a radio, inside a cinema. The comparison is ours; it does not claim that this passage caused a broadcasting or film tradition.

The medium changes who can hear, when they can hear, and whether they can answer. A radio performance cannot rely on a face being visible. A film can hold on a face while speech falls away. Literature can let a narrator interrupt both the action and the reader’s confidence. Each makes room for a different kind of attention.

Stories that return in another form

There are concrete adaptation paths through the book. କା (Kaa) carries Kanhucharan Mohanty’s novel into film; the Gour-Parbati archive identifies the source and the directing collaboration.[3] ଭୂଖା (Bhukha) grew from Manglu Charan Biswal’s play, placing the livelihood of folk performers within a Sambalpuri screen story.[4] ପ୍ରତୀକ୍ଷା (Pratikshya) draws on Gourahari Das’s story, a connection described in the cast-and-crew account at IFFI.[5] BookMyShow’s film listing for ଅନନ୍ତ (Ananta) identifies Fakir Mohan Senapati’s Randi Pua Ananta as its literary source.[6]

These connections should not be flattened into one timeless regional style. A novel, a play and a short story offer different ways of arranging people and events. Sambalpuri speech and performance carry their own local relationships. A new adaptation also belongs to the time in which it is made: to its actors, its audience and the practical circumstances of production.

Carrying the words forward

The literary connection can become a reading path rather than a decorative quotation. Read a source passage, watch the available film or official excerpt, and compare a specific decision: who speaks, whose point of view is retained, and what the new form leaves unsaid. Keep the writer's and translator's names beside the words. A borrowed line should bring its context with it.

For Project Odisha, the page and the screen can therefore lead readers back to one another. A film may draw someone towards a writer; a story may send someone looking for a performance. The task is to keep those doors open, with sources that can be found and voices that remain distinct.

From the page, we move to a maker who carried literary work into cinema. Parbati Ghose's credits let us follow the collaboration through which a story takes another form.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

04 Parbati Ghose: the woman behind the credits



AI-generated editorial illustration; not a film still, documentary photograph or reconstruction of a documented scene.

Sometimes the most revealing way into a film career is to stay for the credits.

In the published credits for ଛଅମାଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ୍ଠ *(Chha Mana Atha Guntha)*, Parbati Ghose appears as producer, director and performer. The screenplay and dialogue are credited to Shrabani, identified there as Parbati Ghose. The archive dates this adaptation of Fakir Mohan Senapati's novel to 1986.[1]

Those entries ask us to look beyond the familiar photograph of an actress. They place her in the decisions that turn a literary work into a

screen production: what to retain, how to organise it, how it should sound, and how it can be made.



Parbati Ghose on India Post's 2023 commemorative stamp. India Post, Government of India, via Wikimedia Commons, Government Open Data License-India. The complete stamp is shown; this is a commemorative portrait, not a film still.

A career built through collaboration

The Gour-Parbati archive records her as co-producer with Gour Prasad Ghose on ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ *(Laxmi)*, କା *(Kaa)* and ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ *(Stree)*. It also identifies "Siddharth," the directing credit associated with *Kaa* and *Stree*, as a collaboration involving Ram Chandra Thakur, Gour and Parbati.[2]

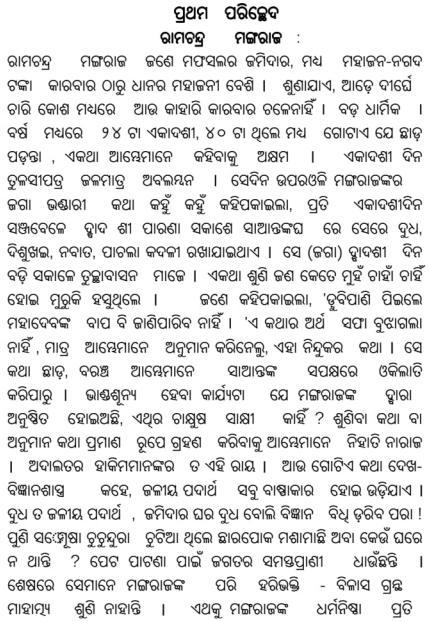
Her producing, directing and writing credits sit alongside the work of these collaborators.

Land, power and a literary inheritance

The novel at the centre of Parbati's adaptation concerns Mangaraj, a moneylender who exploits the colonial legal order to acquire other people's property. Among those he ruins are the weaver couple Bhagia and Saria. Peter Samuels explains how the story turns the workings of law and rural power into satire.[3]

This is the adaptation's literary context. The novel's treatment of property and unequal power provides a starting point for comparison; it does not establish how the film handles every passage or scene.

When a novel becomes a film



ପ୍ରଥମ ପରିଚ୍ଛେଦ

ରାମଚନ୍ଦ୍ର ମଙ୍ଗରାଜ :

ରାମଚନ୍ଦ୍ର ମଙ୍ଗରାଜ ଜଣେ ମଫସଲର ଜମିଦାର, ମଧ୍ୟ ମହାଜନ-ନଗଦ ଟଙ୍କା କାରବାର ଠାରୁ ଧାନର ମହାଜନୀ ବେଶି । ଶୁଣାଯାଏ, ଆଢ଼େ ଦୀର୍ଘେ ଚାରି କୋଶ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ଆଉ କାହାରି କାରବାର ଚଳେନାହିଁ । ବଡ଼ ଧାର୍ମିକ । ବର୍ଷ ମଧ୍ୟରେ ୨୪ ଟା ଏକାଦଶୀ, ୪୦ ଟା ଥିଲେ ମଧ୍ୟ ଗୋଟାଏ ଯେ ଛାଡ଼ ପଡ଼ନ୍ତା , ଏକଥା ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ କହିବାକୁ ଅକ୍ଷମ । ଏକାଦଶୀ ଦିନ ତୁଳସୀପତ୍ର ଜଳମାତ୍ର ଅବଲମ୍ବନ । ସେଦିନ ଉପରଓଳି ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କର ଜଗା ଭଣ୍ଡାରୀ ଜଥା କହୁଁ କହୁଁ କହିପକାଇଲା, ପ୍ରତି ଏକାଦଶୀଦିନ ସଞ୍ଜବେଳେ ଦ୍ୱାଦ ଶୀ ପାରଣା ସକାଶେ ସାଆନ୍ତଙ୍କଘ ରେ ସେରେ ଦୁଧ, ଦିଶୁଖଇ, ନବାତ, ପାଚଲା କଦଳୀ ରଖାଯାଇଥାଏ । ସେ (ଜଗା) ଦ୍ୱାଦଶୀ ଦିନ ବଡ଼ି ସକାଳେ ତୁଚ୍ଛାବାସନ ମାଜେ । ଏଜଥା ଶୁଣି ଜଣ କେତେ ମୁହଁ ଚାହାଁ ଚାହିଁ ହୋଇ ମୁରୁକି ହସୁଥିଲେ । ଜଣେ କହିପକାଇଲା, 'ଡୁବିପାଣି ପିଇଲେ ମହାଦେବଙ୍କ ବାପ ବି ଜାଣିପାରିବ ନାହିଁ । 'ଏ କଥାର ଅର୍ଥ ସଫା ବୁଝାଗଲା ନାହିଁ , ମାତ୍ର ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ ଅନୁମାନ କରିନେଲୁ, ଏହା ନିନ୍ଦୁକର କଥା । ସେ କଥା ଛାଡ଼, ବରଞ୍ଚ ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ ସାଆନ୍ତଙ୍କ ସପକ୍ଷରେ ଓକିଲାତି କରିପାରୁ । ଭାଣ୍ଡଶୂନ୍ୟ ହେବା କାର୍ଯ୍ୟଟା ଯେ ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କ ଦ୍ୱାରା ଅନୁଷ୍ଠିତ ହୋଇଅଛି, ଏଥିର ଚାକ୍ଷୁଷ ସାକ୍ଷୀ କାହିଁ ? ଶୁଣିବା କଥା ବା ଅନୁମାନ କଥା ପ୍ରମାଣ ରୂପେ ଗ୍ରହଣ କରିବାକୁ ଆମ୍ଭେମାନେ ନିହାତି ନାରାଜ । ଅଦାଲତର ହାକିମମାନଙ୍କର ତ ଏହି ରାୟ । ଆଉ ଗୋଟିଏ କଥା ଦେଖ- ବିଜ୍ଞାନଶାସ୍ତ୍ର କହେ, ଜଳୀୟ ପଦାର୍ଥ ସବୁ ବାଷ୍ପାକାର ହୋଇ ଉଡ଼ିଯାଏ । ଦୁଧ ତ ଜଳୀୟ ପଦାର୍ଥ , ଜମିଦାର ଘର ଦୁଧ ବୋଲି ବିଜ୍ଞାନ ବିଧି ଡ଼ରିବ ପରା ! ପୁଣି ସଂଶ୍ଳେଷା ଚୁଚୁନ୍ଦୁରା ଚୁଟିଆ ଥିଲେ ଛାରପୋକ ମଶାମାଛି ଅବା କେଉଁ ଘରେ ନ ଥାନ୍ତି ? ପେଟ ପାଟଣା ପାଇଁ ଜଗତର ସମସ୍ତପ୍ରାଣୀ ଧାଉଁଛନ୍ତି । ଶେଷରେ ସେମାନେ ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କ ପରି ହରିଭକ୍ତି - ବିକାସ ଗ୍ରନ୍ଥ ମାହାତ୍ମ୍ୟ ଶୁଣି ନାହାନ୍ତି । ଏଥକୁ ମଙ୍ଗରାଜଙ୍କ ଧର୍ମନିଷ୍ଠା ପ୍ରତି

Opening chapter of Fakir Mohan Senapati's Chha Mana Atha Guntha, from the digitised text. Digitisation: Srujanika and NIT Rourkela; Wikimedia Commons, CC0. Full page rendered from PDF page 4. This is literary context, not a film poster or a copy documented as used during production.

In the adaptation, Parbati played Saria, Bijay Mohanty played Bhagia and Sarat Pujari played Mangaraj. The archive names Ashok Swain for camera, Tapas Mukherjee for editing and Prafulla Kar for music.[1]

These credits give the relationship between literature and film a concrete form. A novel's words must meet actors' voices, images, cuts and music. Adaptation is a sequence of artistic decisions made by several people, even where one filmmaker carries unusually broad responsibility.

Remembering the work accurately

The archive records national recognition for *Laxmi*, *Kaa* and *Stree* as film honours.[4]

Returning to the credits changes the familiar portrait: the performer also helped decide how the film would be made.

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Film information: ଛଅ ମଣ ଆଠ ଗୁଣ (Chha Mana Atha Guntha).** Gour-Parbati archive: credits and production context, not a player.

- **Film information: ଲକ୍ଷ୍ମୀ (Laxmi).** Gour-Parbati archive.

- **Film information: କା (Kaa).** Gour-Parbati archive.

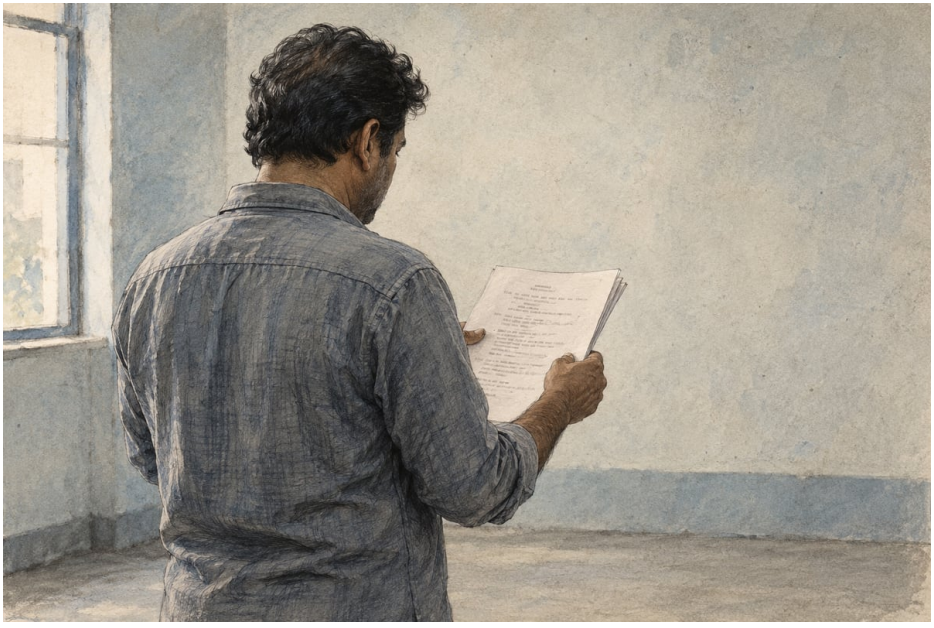
- **Film information: ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ (Stree).** Gour-Parbati archive. An authorised full-film route was not established in this check.

- **Song clip: ସ୍ତ୍ରୀ (Stree) - Kali Juga.** GPG Productions, the channel linked by the Gour-Parbati archive; a song excerpt, not the full film.

Credits can also lead across languages. From Parbati Ghose's overlapping responsibilities, we turn to Sadhu Meher and consider how acting and directing offer different entrances into one career.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

05 Sadhu Meher: an actor beyond one language



AI-generated editorial illustration using Human Natural Editorial mode; not a film still and not a depiction of Sadhu Meher or a historical performance.

A history of Odia cinema needs more than one map. There is the map of films made in the language. There is also the map of artists from Odisha whose work travelled through other film cultures.

Sadhu Meher belongs on both. The 22nd National Film Awards catalogue records his Best Actor award for ଅଙ୍କୁର *(Ankur)*, a Hindi film of 1974. Its biographical note identifies his Odisha background and his training at the Film and Television Institute of India.[1]

His national breakthrough came through Hindi cinema; his work as an Odia director would give that journey another direction.

Kishtaya: the man who comes back

In *Ankur*, Meher plays Kishtaya, husband of Lakshmi, played by Shabana Azmi. Anant Nag plays Surya, the landlord's son.[2] The national-awards catalogue describes Kishtaya as a poor potter. After leaving the village following public humiliation, he returns with earnings and accepts his wife's approaching motherhood. When he goes to Surya seeking work, he is beaten; Lakshmi intervenes.[1]

The conflict puts employment, dependence and the landlord's power inside a marriage. Kishtaya's return is therefore more than a change in the household: it brings a vulnerable worker back within reach of the person who can decide whether he earns. This is the role behind the award, and a concrete starting point for understanding the actor's place in Indian cinema.



Sadhu Meher receiving the Padma Shri from President Pranab Mukherjee on 13 April 2017. Photograph: President's Secretariat, Government of India, via Wikimedia Commons; Government Open Data License-India. Original photograph retained in full. The honour pictured is distinct from his National Film Award for Ankur.

The actor was also a director

Kapilas Bhuyan's 2010 retrospective credits Meher's ଅଭିମାନ *(Abhiman)* (1977) with helping revive cinema attendance.[3]

Uttam Mohanty recalled meeting Meher, who photographed him and cast him in *Abhiman*. In the 2018 interview, Mohanty described obtaining his family's permission and completing the shoot in 35 days.[4] The recollection supplies an actor's account of entering a production Meher directed.

The official 60th National Film Awards catalogue later listed him as chair of its South I feature-film jury panel. Its biography recorded six

directed feature films by that point. That number belongs to the catalogue's period, not to a verified final career count.[5]

The same biography records work in acting, feature direction and television.[5]

Ankur and *Abhiman* offer two entrances into that career: the role of Kishtaya, and an Odia film he directed. Following both keeps his work behind the camera beside the performance for which he received national recognition.

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Full-film listing: ଅଙ୍କୁର (Ankur) on Shemaroo's YouTube channel.** Official-channel upload identified in the indexed listing; playback and regional access untested.

- **Film information: ଅଭିମାନ (Abhiman) in an IFFI retrospective.** Historical account of the Odia film, not a stream.

A career takes shape through individual choices and the people who make them possible. Manmohan Mahapatra's chapter brings that attention to households under pressure and to the collaborators who helped give them form.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

06 Manmohan Mahapatra: households under pressure



AI-generated editorial illustration; not a film still, documentary photograph or reconstruction of a documented scene.

In କ୍ଲାନ୍ତ ଅପରାହ୍ନ *(Klanta Aparanha)*, retired Adikanda lives with his mother and daughter Niru. Niru teaches alongside Sandhya and Veena, with whom she exchanges news and hopes. An anticipated marriage proposal draws the family into financial pressure: Adikanda mortgages land to raise money for the dowry.[1]

The premise brings a social expectation into one household. Marriage becomes a question of property and security as well as affection. In his account of Odisha's new-wave cinema, critic Ashok Palit discusses Mahapatra's films through changing rural society and tensions within families.[2]

The journey from training to recognition

The 1985 Indian Panorama catalogue identifies Mahapatra as a graduate of Utkal University who completed film-direction studies at FTII in 1975. It dates the making of ଶୀତରାତି *(Seeta Raati)* to 1976 and its national recognition to 1982.[1]

The 29th National Film Awards catalogue lists *Seeta Raati* as Best Oriya Film in the awards for 1981.[3]



Prabhat Studio Complex at FTII, Pune, photographed in 2018. Photograph: DesiBoy101, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0. A later view of the institution where Mahapatra studied direction; not a location from his films.

Read the collaborators, too

For *Klanta Aparanha*, the Panorama catalogue names Nandalal Mahapatra for the story, Ranajit Ray for cinematography, Satyendra Mohanty for editing and Shantanu Mahapatra for music.[1]

The story, images, editing and music carry separate credits. They offer a route into how this particular production was made.

Working with the filmmaker

Colleagues' recollections add another view of his practice. In Bijay Mandal's 2020 retrospective, actor Jayaswami described his help in developing her work while keeping actors within their characters. Susant Mani recalled subtitling and mentorship; Pradeep Mohanty remembered borrowing Mahapatra's 35mm camera rather than hiring one from Madras.[4]

Looking beyond the award

The proposed marriage in *Klanta Aparanha* makes property part of the family's future. Maya Miriga offers another household through which to explore the competing responsibilities of family life.

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Official catalogue:** ଶୀତରାତି **(Seeta Raati).** National Film Awards catalogue, page 53; not streaming.

- **Official catalogue:** କ୍ଳାନ୍ତ ଅପରାହ୍ନ **(Klanta Aparanha).** Indian Panorama 1985. No authorised full-film route was established in this check.

Another household offers another arrangement of affection, obligation and ambition. With Maya Miriga, the question of how a film sees family becomes inseparable from the work that lets us encounter the film again.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

07 ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga): a family, a fragile film, a second life



AI-generated editorial illustration; not a film still, documentary photograph or reconstruction of a documented scene.

In January 2025, an Odia film made four decades earlier appeared on the programme of New York's Museum of Modern Art. ମାୟା ମିରିଗ *(Maya Miriga)* was being shown in its restored form, as part of the museum's film-preservation festival.[1]

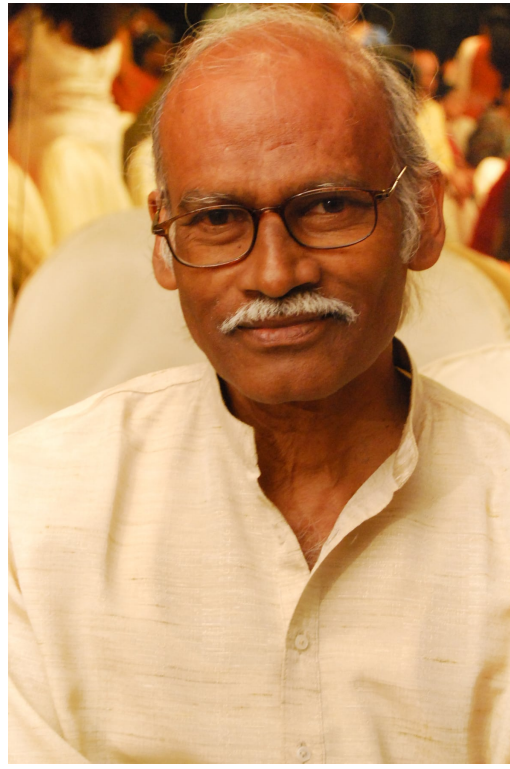
A film has more than one lifetime. There is the time lived by its characters, the time spent making it, and the later years in which its images must survive. The restoration story asks us to hold all three together.

There are two journeys here. One belongs to a film that found audiences far from the place where it was made. The other belongs to the physical material that had to survive for those audiences to keep finding it.

A household large enough to hold a world

Nirad Mohapatra's 1984 film follows an extended middle-class family in a small Odisha town. MoMA's account describes a household pulled between obligations and individual ambitions, brought to life by a nonprofessional cast and Bhaskar Chandavarkar's music.[1]

Mohapatra's own note, reproduced in the Bologna programme, describes married sons balancing competing responsibilities and daughters-in-law seeking freedom within the household. His interest held affection and frustration together: family could offer warmth while also constraining the people who lived within it.[2]



Nirad Mohapatra, 2010. Photograph: Raj Sampad, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0. Reproduced without cropping.

Different doors into the world

The film was selected for Cannes Critics' Week in 1984. Mannheim's 1984 archive records it in the Grand Prize of the Third World competition, shared with ଲଇଲା ଏ ଜଲ ଜୁ *(Leila et les loups)*; that category was distinct from the festival's overall Grand Prize.[3, 4]

At home, it received the Second Best Feature Film recognition in the 31st National Film Awards, covering films of 1983 and presented in 1984.[5]

The national award, Cannes selection and Mannheim prize trace different parts of its circulation.

The work of bringing a film back

The negative had been found abandoned in a warehouse in poor condition, according to Film Heritage Foundation's Shivendra Singh Dungarpur in the Bologna programme.[2]

The restored version was assembled from a 16mm original camera negative and a 35mm print. MoMA credits Film Heritage Foundation's 4K restoration at L'Immagine Ritrovata in Bologna, using material preserved by the foundation and NFDC-National Film Archive of India.[1]

Bologna's programme also credits the director's family, Digital Film Restore for digital restoration, and Prasad Corporation for scanning.[2]

The restoration was screened at Il Cinema Ritrovato in Bologna on 27 June 2024.[2]

Prabha, the eldest son Tuku's wife, is played by Manaswini Mangaraj.[2, 6]

Writing after that screening, film historian Antti Alanen placed her at the film's emotional centre and traced the family's tensions through gender and generation. He admired its atmosphere and music, while also finding moments when it lacked intensity.[6]

The restoration makes an encounter with the film possible again, alongside the work of the people who kept it available. Alanen's response is one example of the new discussion that can follow an old film's return.

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Restoration clip and information: ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) at Film Heritage Foundation.** Restoration story and before-and-after comparison clip; not the full film.

Preserving a film and sustaining a performance tradition raise different questions about continuity. Bhukha shifts our attention towards working musicians, their livelihoods, and the audiences a filmmaker hopes to reach.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

08 ଭୁଖା (Bhukha): when a tradition must also feed a family



AI-generated editorial illustration; not a film still, documentary photograph or reconstruction of a documented scene.

A tradition can be admired long after the people who practise it have begun to struggle. The drum remains a symbol; the drummer still needs to earn a living.

A drumbeat can carry a gathering; it cannot, by itself, settle what the drummer will earn. Listening closely means making room for both the sound and the life that sustains it.

ଭୁଖା *(Bhukha)* offers one starting point for exploring cinema in western Odisha. Sabyasachi Mohapatra's 1989 Sambalpuri film places folk

performers within a changing society. Film critic Ashok Palit discusses it as an encounter between inherited ways of life and modernity.[1]

Behind the sound, a livelihood

The film grew from a play by Manglu Charan Biswal. A later report about Mohapatra's work describes its concern with bajnia folk drummers whose livelihoods were threatened by changing musical tastes.[2]

For a working musician, cultural change can arrive as the loss of the next engagement. The film's subject brings an economic question into the celebration of inherited art: what allows a performer to continue?



Sabyasachi Mohapatra, photographed at the Odisha State Film Awards in Bhubaneswar, 21 November 2014. Photograph: Subhashish Panigrahi; existing crop by MKar. Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0. A portrait of the director, not a still from Bhukha.

Ramesh Mahanand's music offers a more specific way into the film. Himanshu Shekhar Guru's 2015 account in *OrissaPOST* identifies a Nachnia song and a Sajani geet in its musical repertoire.[3] These named forms connect its music with the livelihood conflict.

Finding an audience at home

In a 2022 interview, Mohapatra recalled that *Bhukha* did well in western Odisha and also reached audiences in Bhubaneswar, Cuttack and Puri. Looking back on the broader difficulties of distributing his films, he described the separate expense of posters, banners and promotion. Completing a film was only one part of bringing it to viewers.[4]

That recollection gives the film another geography. Its journey was not only towards an international festival; it also ran between western Odisha and the coastal cities. These are the director's memories of reception, rather than audited box-office figures.

A regional voice reaching another audience

The official 70th National Film Awards catalogue credits *Bhukha* with an International Jury Award at Gijón. This institutional retrospective supports the recognition; it does not settle the award's exact year in the material examined here.[5]

Amrit Amlan Pattanaik's study places Mohapatra's Sambalpuri films within western Odisha's literary and cultural worlds.[6] That regional focus offers another route through the films, alongside their festival record.

Following the filmmaker forward

Mohapatra's later work gives this story another chapter. ଆଦିମ ବିଚାର *(Aadim Vichar)* received the Best Odiya Film award in the 62nd National Film Awards, announced in March 2015 for films of 2014.[7]

One question to explore in *Bhukha* is how a cultural practice and its practitioners' livelihoods depend on one another. Mohapatra's recollection of bringing the film to viewers adds a related question: what does it take for a story about working performers to find an audience?

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Institutional reference: Sabyasachi Mohapatra and ଭୁଖ (Bhukha).** National Film Awards catalogue, printed page 036. A director biography, not a player; an authorised full-film route was not established in this check.

A story's language, its setting and its maker's relationship to a place need not describe the same connection. Nandita Das's chapter follows those distinctions through family memory, acting and directing.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

09 Nandita Das: roots, routes and the stories between



AI-generated editorial illustration using Human Natural Editorial mode; not a film still and not a depiction of Nandita Das or an actual rehearsal.

For Nandita Das, the journey to Baripada was part of childhood. In a 2013 essay, she recalled summer visits to her father's family home and the anticipation of arriving. She was born in Bombay and grew up in Delhi; her father, artist Jatin Das, connected her to Odisha.[1]



Nandita Das, 2008. Image credited on Wikimedia Commons to user Nanditadas, CC BY-SA 3.0. Original image reproduced without cropping; venue not identified.

Acting in Odia: Biswaprakash

Her connection to Odia cinema also includes acting in the language. She appears in ବିଶ୍ୱପ୍ରକାଶ *(Biswaprakash / The Young Rebel)*, Susant Misra's 1999 film. Her official acting filmography lists the work, and the national-awards catalogue names her in its cast.[2]

The film received Best Feature Film in Oriya recognition for 1999 at the 47th National Film Awards. This was a film honour, with awards to the producer and director, not an individual acting award for Das.[2]

That credit adds a direct professional connection to the family memories with which this story begins: Odisha is also part of her work as a performer.

What Cannes recognises

Cannes records Das as a member of its feature-film jury in 2005 and its Cinéfondation and short-film jury in 2013. It also lists ମଣ୍ଟୋ *(Manto)*, which she directed and wrote, in the 2018 Un Certain Regard selection.[3]

These records distinguish jury service from the selection of her own film.

Manto: a writer between two cities

Manto follows the writer Saadat Hasan Manto through Partition and the move from Bombay to Lahore. Cannes' synopsis describes a life unsettled by separation, difficulty publishing and obscenity trials. Das wrote and directed the film.[4]

The subject gives the festival entry a human shape: a writer whose ability to describe his world is tested by upheaval and prosecution. Beside ଜ୍ୱିଗାଟୋ *(Zwigato)*, it offers a second way into Das's choice of stories - one concerned with a writer's freedom, the other with the pressures of earning a living.

Bhubaneswar, seen through working lives

With *Zwigato*, Odisha becomes the setting of a film she directs. The official synopsis places a delivery rider and his family in Bhubaneswar, where changing employment shapes both his work and his wife's search for opportunities. The film's official page lists Hindi and Odia as its languages.[5]

In her director's note, Das describes the challenge of making ratings, incentives and algorithmic work legible through human lives. The same page records festival premieres at Toronto, Busan and Kerala in 2022.[5]

Baripada belongs to her family memory; *Biswaprakash* to her acting work in Odia; *Zwigato* to her work in Odisha as a director. These connections sit alongside *Manto* and the other films in a career across languages.

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Paid provider listing:** ବିଶ୍ୱପ୍ରକାଶ **(Biswaprakash) on Prime Video.** Check current availability and account terms; regional responses differed during verification.

- **Provider catalogue:** ମଣ୍ଟୋ **(Manto) on Netflix.** The 2018 Nandita Das film. Unavailable in the returned locale during verification; this is not a current-playback assurance.

- **Paid provider listing:** ଜ୍ୱିଗାଟୋ **(Zwigato) on Prime Video.** Check local availability; indexed regional listings differed.

- **Filmmaker's page and trailer:** ଜ୍ୱିଗାଟୋ **(Zwigato).** Official film page with a trailer link, not a full-film stream.

Stories about working lives also ask whose experience comes forward. DAMaN brings that question into the relationship between a central character, the people around him and the wider history behind the film.

PART 2 · FILMS AND FILMMAKERS

10 ଦମନ (DAMaN): the road from Malkangiri to national recognition



AI-generated editorial illustration using Human Natural Editorial mode; not a film still and not a real camp, identifiable community or medical procedure.

The story began with another film that needed making. In 2020, Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka travelled to Malkangiri for a documentary assignment about malaria prevention. What stayed with them was the work: doctors, ASHA and anganwadi workers, and staff from other departments reaching distant villages. Mourya later recalled that encounter as the inspiration for ଦମନ *(DAMaN)*.[1]

On **16 August 2024**, *DAMaN* was announced as **Best Odia Film at the 70th National Film Awards**, which honoured films of **2022**.

The official record names producer JP Motion Pictures and directors Vishal Mourya and Debi Prasad Lenka.[2]

For Odia cinema, this was another chapter in a long history of national recognition. For this particular film, it marked the distance travelled by a story rooted in the difficult business of getting care to people.

A doctor who has to decide whether to stay

The National Film Awards catalogue places the story in 2015. Its young doctor, Siddharth, arrives in Malkangiri and struggles with the conditions of his posting before committing himself to tackling malaria. Babushaan Mohanty plays the doctor; Dipanwit Dashmohapatra plays the pharmacist who works alongside him.[3, 4]

The premise raises a question: what happens when an assignment becomes a responsibility a person can no longer walk away from? The film gives that question a particular location and profession.



Babushaan Mohanty, photographed in 2018, before DAMaN. Photograph: Jnanaranjan Sahu, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 4.0. Original close-up retained uncropped and without AI modification. A real photograph of the lead actor, not a film still.

Babushaan told *Indulge* that he spoke with doctors while preparing for the role. He also described the Hindi release as fulfilling his wish to take his industry to a national audience. The ambition he expressed was to carry work from Odisha further while continuing to belong to its film industry.[5]

The people beyond the central character

A feature film can organise a complex effort around one protagonist. The history behind it needs a wider frame.

That choice also drew criticism. Atri Prasad Rout, writing in *OrissaPOST*, admired the filmmaking but warned that building the story around a single doctor risked making an outsider into a saviour.[6] In *Countercurrents*, Pradyumna Behera argued that the film gave too

little space to Adivasi agency and the history behind unequal access to healthcare.[7] These readings ask whose experience a story brings forward when it follows the person arriving to help.

The real programme's name is **Durgama Anchalare Malaria Nirakarana**. Odisha's Health and Family Welfare Department describes DAMaN as an intervention in remote, inaccessible and other high-burden villages. Its 2022-23 report records 1,817 camps during 2022 and more than half a million people screened.[8]

Those figures record services delivered. The programme was implemented from 2017, distinct from the film's 2015 setting. An evaluation of malaria camps reported reduced infection odds in its early-camp group, while cautioning that its non-randomised design could not establish causation. It concerns the programme, not the film's effects.[9]

Health workers offer another view of the effort. In interviews published in 2025, 53 workers across five districts described infrastructure, workforce and resource constraints, and proposed more flexible camp schedules and support for volunteers. Their accounts bring the daily organisation of care into view. These were workers' perspectives from districts outside Malkangiri, rather than residents' accounts of the place depicted in the film.[10]

A resident's account brings those access barriers closer. In a 2023 *Down To Earth* report, a Bonda resident of Sanuguda in Malkangiri, identified under the changed name Raja Kirsani, described a walk of more than three hours to reach care because ambulances could not reach his village. His testimony concerns healthcare access, not a response to *DAMaN*.[11]

A cinema story and a programme history can illuminate each other while answering different questions. The fictional doctor gives the film a central journey; the wider record makes room for the repeated work of teams and volunteers.

Making the story travel

Mourya said the production drew performers from the Koraput and Jeypore film societies, alongside the lead actors and other local talent. The award catalogue credits Pratap Rout for cinematography and Debi Prasad Lenka for editing.[1, 3]

DAMaN opened in Odia on **4 November 2022**. Its Hindi version reached cinemas on **3 February 2023**. The second release made the story available to another audience; it should not be confused with a separate original Hindi film.[5, 4]

The reception was not uniform. *Film Information*, reviewing the Hindi version, praised the lead performances but found the screenplay slow and its dramatic appeal limited. That contemporary dissent belongs beside the later national honour. Recognition does not require every audience or critic to respond in the same way.[4]

Recognition and the questions that remain

The film's production, releases and national award document its journey to wider attention. The responses gathered here also leave a question for viewers: how does following one doctor shape the space given to the people around him? The accounts of workers and residents bring their own histories of care and access; they are not a measure of the film's reception.

Watch and explore

Links checked on 26 October 2026. Playback was not tested; territory, account and payment conditions can change.

- **Full-film listing: ଦମନ (DAMaN) on Amara Muzik Odia's YouTube channel.** Verified official-channel page displayed a 1:58:31 player. Playback was not started; access elsewhere is not guaranteed.

- **Official trailer: ଦମନ (DAMaN).** Amara Muzik Odia; a trailer, not the full film.

The final part widens the frame from individual films to recurring encounters with stories. Television brings different schedules, production demands and opportunities for viewers to return to characters over time.

PART 3 · CHANGING SCREENS

11 Odia television and the stories that came home



AI-generated Editorial Natural illustration; not an archival photograph, programme still or reconstruction of a documented home.

A cinema screening asks viewers to enter a theatre. A television serial asks them to return to a story. Its characters can become familiar through repetition: a conversation continues tomorrow, a conflict develops over weeks, and a household's ordinary routines become the setting for drama.

For Odia storytelling, television added a different relationship between performers and audiences. It brought pictures into the domestic space already occupied by radio, and created a continuing demand for programmes. Its history belongs beside AIR Cuttack and Odia cinema, with room for their shared writers, performers, music and audiences. These media continued together; none simply erased the one before it.

A film actor on the small screen

କେମିତି କହିବି କହ **(Kemiti Kahibi Kaha)** offers a concrete connection between television and cinema's performers. ZEE5's programme page identifies **Siddhant Mohapatra** and **Supriya Nayak** in its cast and dates the Odia drama to 2021. Its central relationship brings a wealthy businessman and a younger woman into a story about love and an age difference.[1]

A familiar screen performer can meet viewers in a new rhythm here. Instead of a single feature-length encounter, a serial permits repeated meetings with a character. That difference creates possibilities for development, while also placing pressure on a story to sustain its course.

Before the satellite channel

Prasar Bharati's 2010-11 annual report traces a production centre in Cuttack to September 1973 and an Upagraha Kendra to August 1974, preparing programmes for the Satellite Instructional Television Experiment. It records Sambalpur's terrestrial service from 30 April 1978, local Odia programmes from Cuttack in November 1987, and the inauguration of the Bhubaneswar complex in November 1992. Production, transmission and a dedicated language channel were different stages of development.[2]

The experiment's educational purpose matters. Television was being considered as a way to address dispersed communities, rather than only as a delivery system for entertainment. Mrinal Chatterjee's historical account identifies Dhenkanal, Sambalpur and Phulbani among Odisha's SITE districts in 1975-76.[3]

A public platform for stories

Prasar Bharati dates the Odia Regional Language Satellite Service to **2 October 1993**, initially named DD-5. It records the change to DD-6 on **15 August 1994**, followed by round-the-clock broadcasting on **1 April 2001**. These are satellite-channel milestones, not Odisha's first television broadcasts.[4]

The broadcaster describes a programme mix spanning literature, folk music, dance, agriculture, news and festivals. Its public catalogue links କଥା ସରିତ। **(Katha Sarita)** stories and ଗୋପାଳ ରହସ୍ୟ **(Gopala Rahasya)**, alongside a programme identified with Godabarisha Mishra's ପାଣୁ ମିଶ୍ର **(Panu Mishra)**. The catalogue connects literary and oral storytelling with television.[4]

A retrospective of Manmohan Mahapatra's work lists *Rakta Tirtha Eram* (1997) and *Nua Sakala* (2000) for DDK Bhubaneswar. These are dates in the retrospective's work list, not independently established broadcast dates.[5]

A televised story has choices that radio handles differently. A face can hold a pause; an entrance can be shown rather than announced. Yet dialogue, timing and the listener's attention still matter. The change is in the tools available to the storyteller, not a measure of which medium is more accomplished.

Cable and private channels broaden the schedule

Odisha Television Network dates its beginnings to a cable service in Bhubaneswar and Cuttack in 1997, and its move to satellite broadcasting to 2006. That news-oriented history belongs alongside entertainment television, rather than standing in for it.[6]

Chatterjee's account describes ETV's arrival in the early 2000s and the expansion of Odia entertainment through Tarang in 2008. It also

credits independent producer Biren Das with the 1995 news magazine *Ajira Odisha*: production initiatives mattered as well as channel ownership.[3]

A later corporate milestone was ZEE's acquisition of Sarthak Entertainment. Its financial notes record the company becoming a wholly owned subsidiary on **4 December 2015**, identifying Sarthak TV as an Odia general-entertainment channel. This was an acquisition, not the channel's founding date.[7]

These developments created different places for a programme to be commissioned and encountered: public broadcasting, a local cable service and competing entertainment schedules.

Animation, and the language a child hears

A drawn figure can carry a familiar story into a new room. But animation is a way of making images, not an age category: an animated short, a television serial and a feature film have different lengths, audiences and routes to a screen.

IDMT's own catalogue records ଚତୁର କାଉ (Chatura Kau) as an Odia animated short released on 14 January 2008. It also describes ଧର୍ମପଦ (Dharmapada) as an animated feature project. The short and the proposed feature show different ambitions within local animation.[8]

କୁନି ଗଣେଶ (Kuni Ganesha) provides a television connection. Reporting on Media Pixels Productions described an eight-episode Odia 3D series prepared for Doordarshan, with Gouri Shankar Singh as producer and Jyotiranjan Swain as writer-director. The account also records the difficulty of bringing funding and technology together.[9]

A later example connects local production to national broadcasting. ELE Animations' announcement for ଜୟ ଜଗନ୍ନାଥ (Jay Jagannath) describes its collaboration with Toonz and Warner Bros. Discovery and a Pogo premiere in May 2024. The six announced broadcast languages

did not include Odia. This belongs to Odisha's animation and cultural history, but that announcement is not evidence of an Odia-language broadcast.[10]

The distinction continues into features. ELE's ମହାପ୍ରଭୁ ଜଗନ୍ନାଥ (Mahaprabhu Jagannath), directed by Shripad Warkhedkar, received a trade review recording a Bombay theatrical release on 4 September 2026. Producer publicity named Odia among its planned languages. An advertised language does not establish that an Odia-language screening took place.[11, 12]

These productions also widen the economics story. ELE's agreement announcement describes distribution, licensing and merchandising alongside the series itself. Such rights offer possible income beyond tickets; the announcement provides no audited return.[13]

For a child, the voice matters as much as the drawing. Original Odia stories, Odia voice performances and translations of work made elsewhere can all contribute to a viewing culture. A future catalogue should identify which is which, credit writers and voice artists, and link to authorised versions rather than assume every cartoon labelled "Odia" was produced in Odisha.

The people keeping the pictures on air

The expanding schedules depended on different kinds of teamwork, from a live festival broadcast to a serial delivered on time.

Participant **Fakira Mohan Nahak** recalls ETV's **12 July 2002** Rath Yatra coverage as a coordinated operation: **Sanjay Pathak** led the Puri field team, broadcast engineer **Akshay Mohanty** handled the technical system, **Amitabh Bhattashali** led the Hyderabad team and **Vijay Krishna** handled panel production. Nahak also describes arranging graphics for the transition to live pictures. Those named roles - and the wider crew - made the broadcast possible.[14]

The work behind the returning characters

Serials need actors, but also writers, camera crews, editors, sound workers, makeup artists and the people who keep a production running. The promise of regular episodes creates work and a demanding timetable.

In a January 2025 interview, director **Mihir Swain**, then working on Tarang's *Rajayoga*, described how more broadcast days had led to longer shoots and less time to prepare episodes ahead. Producer **Akshay Parija** identified irregular delivery of outsourced stories as another obstacle. Actor **Sarmili** described the insecurity of promised roles being reassigned and the difficulty of depending on serial income. These are accounts of their working lives, not a census of every production.[15]

More episodes can create more work, while preparation time, pay and continuity of employment remain concerns in these interviews. The production schedule gives the channel history another scale: the time and resources available to make the next episode.

Television also travels through the internet

The same ZEE5 catalogue advertises episodes of *Kemiti Kahibi Kaha* before their television telecast for viewers in India. A television serial can therefore also be an on-demand offering. Watching through an app does not automatically make a work an original web series.[1]

That distinction matters to the Odia OTT journey. Streaming can carry live channels, earlier television episodes, acquired films or productions commissioned specifically for the platform. The device in a viewer's hand cannot tell us, on its own, how a story was financed or made.

Television's continuing importance is not only a question of who owns a channel. It lies in the programmes people can find, the languages and

places they recognise, and the conditions under which the next episode is created.

Watch and explore

Programme links were checked on 25 October 2026; the producer catalogue on 26 October 2026. Playback and current account or regional conditions were not tested.

- **Programme and episode catalogue: କେମିତି କହିବି କହ (Kemiti Kahibi Kaha) on ZEE5.** Check individual episode access and current account terms.

- **Official programme information: DD Odia at Prasar Bharati.** Channel history and linked catalogue; not a promise that every listed programme is available to watch.

- **Producer catalogue:** IDMT's Utkal Cartoon World. Production information, not a verified full-film player.

A programme's journey can continue beyond its broadcast hour. The final chapter asks what changes when stories enter streaming catalogues, and what access, discoverability and sustainable work might mean for viewers and makers.

PART 3 · CHANGING SCREENS

12 The Odia OTT journey and the search for an audience



AI-generated Editorial Natural illustration of an imagined viewer and screen; not a documentary photograph, identifiable location or actual programme still.

For an on-demand viewer, an episode can fit around the day rather than a fixed broadcast hour. A viewer may pause a story, return to it after work, or discover an Odia film far from a cinema that screens it. Streaming changes the circumstances of watching. Whether it also changes the stories depends on the people commissioning, writing and making them.

Odia OTT belongs within the longer history of theatre, radio, television and cinema. It provides another route to audiences, while drawing on works and performers already moving between those media.

What enters the catalogue

OTT, or over-the-top delivery, broadly describes media delivered through the internet. For this history, it helps to distinguish three kinds of offering: live or catch-up television, films acquired for streaming, and productions commissioned for a platform. An app can contain all three. “Original” and “exclusive” also need care: a work available exclusively through one service is not necessarily a work that service originally commissioned.

That is why the Odia journey has several starting points. A broadcaster can extend an existing television library; an independent service can build a catalogue and produce new work; a filmmaker can license a completed film. None requires us to declare a single platform the uncontested first.

From broadcaster to streaming service

A contemporary launch report dates **Tarang Plus** to **27 October 2019**, after an earlier planned launch was delayed. It described a service combining the network’s television channels with films, jatra, early access to serials and original web content. This was a bridge between established broadcasting and a different way of watching.[1]

Chumbak and the possibility of different stories

By March 2020, ଚୁମ୍ବକ **(Chumbak)** was providing a concrete example. MyCityLinks reported on the Tarang Plus series directed by **Susant Mani**, with **Tamanna Vyas** and **Divyadisha Mohanty**, about a same-gender relationship. Mani described the opportunity to experiment within a limited budget; Mohanty discussed preparing for a role that initially took her outside her comfort zone.[2]

The director’s budget and the actor’s preparation describe two parts of making this series. Their accounts give the new commissioning space a specific production, rather than only a catalogue of promised titles.

Independent platforms build another route

Kaushik Das, founder of **AAO NXT**, described a progression from **AAO TV in 2019**, which brought existing online Odia content together, to a fuller OTT service launched in **December 2020**. In his February 2023 interview, he explained that the venture needed both a technology operation and a production unit. His account places the work of building a catalogue beside the work of making originals.[3]

Kanccha Lannka represents another initiative. In a March 2025 interview, co-founder **Bibhu Prasad Rath** dated its establishment to **2021**, with **Akshay Parija** and **CR Nayak**. He named programmes including *Gangs of Puri*, *Barang 1999* and *Okha Express*, and discussed the challenge of meeting production expectations shaped by other language industries.[4]

The two founders describe the work of building a service and a slate. Their accounts establish business intentions and production concerns, rather than independent measures of audience experience.

One critic's encounter

A response to a completed work offers a different perspective from a platform launch. Reviewing Abhishek Swain's anthology *Four* in December 2022, Madhushree Chakrabarty described following its stories as a non-Odia viewer.[5]

Finding a place among other apps

Distribution also changed through bundles. On **12 January 2023**, Tata Play announced the addition of Tarang Plus to its Binge service, alongside other regional platforms. A viewer could encounter Odia programming through a shared subscription interface rather than searching for the standalone app. The announcement establishes another distribution route, not how many people watched or what producers earned.[6]

Language can travel beyond the state

Streaming offers a route to people who cannot attend an Odia theatrical screening nearby. In an April 2025 Mint report, Das described overseas viewers seeking stories that reconnect them with their cultural roots. This is testimony about demand; the report does not establish an Odia-specific overseas revenue percentage.[7]

Language access matters too. Kanccha Lannka's App Store description advertises English subtitles for selected titles. "Selected" is significant: the availability of an app abroad does not mean every programme has subtitles or can be played in every territory.[8]

Subtitles can invite a viewer who does not know Odia into the story. They can also help a younger diaspora viewer follow a language heard at home. Those are possibilities worth pursuing, not evidence that every platform has already reached those audiences successfully.

Reach must become sustainable work

A catalogue needs more than an upload button. Das described the expense of maintaining the platform and producing content, alongside the difficulty of making potential viewers aware of a regional service.[3] For an Odia production, being discoverable is only one part of the business. Payment arrangements, rights, promotion and continued availability shape whether a release supports the next project.

Downloads, registered accounts, paying subscribers, viewing hours and money received by a producer answer different questions. A large number attached to one of them cannot stand in for all the others. Nor does a launch announcement prove that a promised slate was completed.

For viewers, the question is whether a work remains findable and accessible. For makers, it is whether payment and rights arrangements

help support the next production. The cinema overview asks a related question about theatres: how can a willing audience reach the work?

Watch and explore

These links open providers or their app listings, not guaranteed access to a particular film. Check current catalogues, territory and payment terms; playback was not tested.

- **Provider catalogue: AAO NXT.** Homepage checked on 26 October 2026; login and subscription options were visible.

- **Provider app listing: Kanccha Lannka on the App Store.** Listing checked on 25 October 2026. Descriptions of titles or subtitles do not guarantee access in every location.

New screens offer new routes to viewers. Behind each route remain the practical questions of making the work, paying for it and keeping it available.

Between the frames

A film is also work shared among people. These retained photographs bring that work into view, away from the finished screen. Their descriptions identify people and a set; they do not tell us what was being said or decided.



On the set of Sahari Bagha, identified by the Commons description as a photograph of Mohammad Mohsin. Commons credit: MM Junior (Aby), CC BY-SA 4.0. The original photograph date is unverified; 2017 is the digital record date. Reproduced without alteration. Source record; licence.



Pranab Das in conversation with actors Bijay Mohanty and Mihir Das, dated 1989 in the Commons description. Commons author credit: Director Pranab Das; uploaded by Sunny Roy. CC BY-SA 4.0. Original photographer and film not identified in the record; reproduced without alteration. Source record; licence.

PART 4 · MAKING THE NEXT FILM

13 What Makes the Next Film Possible

Making a film, making the next film

A film budget is a promise made before its audience is known. It must turn an idea into paid working days, performances, recorded sound and a finished picture. The economics of Odia cinema therefore belong inside its cultural history: they help explain which work can begin, which work reaches a screen, and which work can be made again. They cannot, by themselves, explain the value of a film.

A loan behind Maya Miriga

ମାୟା ମିରିଗ (Maya Miriga) gives this question a human scale. Speaking at the Odisha Literary Festival in 2024, Sabita Mohanty recalled funding as an obstacle and said Nirad Mohapatra sought a Rs 4 lakh loan from the National Film Development Corporation, repaying it gradually. Her recollection concerns the financing of the 1984 film. It does not establish its complete budget. The distinction matters: borrowed money can make production possible while also creating an obligation that survives the shoot. [1]

We should resist turning this figure into a neat comparison with a present-day production. A loan is not an expenditure ledger; rupees from different decades do not have equal purchasing power; and publicity, distribution and other costs may not be included in a figure called a budget. What the recollection establishes is a relationship between a filmmaker, his family and an institution prepared to advance money. It invites a history of support and repayment rather than a league table of inexpensive masterpieces.

A hit, and the limits of its headline

For a recent commercial example, consider ବୋଉ ବୁଟୁ ଭୂତ (Bou Buttu Bhuta). On 30 June 2025, The Federal reported a production budget of Rs 2-3 crore and almost Rs 12 crore at the box office after 17 days. The Rs 12 crore figure in this account is a receipt estimate, not a production budget. [2] The overview follows later reporting on the run and remake rights; those differently dated accounts should not be treated as one final balance sheet.

Neither report supplies the settlement that reached the producer. Subtracting the reported budget from ticket receipts would therefore answer the wrong question. To estimate producer profit we would need the actual amounts received, the applicable distribution and exhibition arrangements, and the full costs charged to the production. No standard percentage is assumed here. Nor is a reported hit treated as evidence that every film, or even every participant in that hit, prospered.

The audience needs a screen

The overview describes the tension between busy shows and places without convenient cinema access. A successful film and a healthy exhibition network remain different questions.

For the next production, the practical questions are location, showtimes, ticket affordability and the duration of a run. For researchers, they are also questions of measurement. A list of venues is not a count of screens; an opening-day collection is not a lifetime return; a festival audience is not a statewide survey. Keeping these measures separate makes commercial achievements more intelligible, not less significant.

Support is more than a building

OFDC's stated objectives connect several parts of this chain: finance for films, assistance for rural and semi-urban cinemas, studio and processing facilities, and support for film societies. Its 1976 incorporation belongs to a longer history of public involvement than any single redevelopment. These are institutional responsibilities and stated purposes; they are not evidence that every applicant received assistance. [3]

The redevelopment of Kalinga Studio, inaugurated in October 2026, can be judged over time through access to facilities, actual bookings and the productions those facilities help complete. Alongside public provision, the India Cine Hub directory lists Bhubaneswar's Mute Studio as advertising post-production services. A directory entry identifies a possible service provider; it does not establish rates, capacity or a verified production history. [4, 5]

A digital release has costs too

Streaming changes the route to a viewer, but does not abolish the cost of reaching one. The OTT chapter follows the work of building platforms and catalogues. The economic question is what continuing arrangements these outlets can sustain with creators, as well as how many titles they carry.

The useful economic question is consequently larger than which film collected the most. Can one successful release help finance another? Can a filmmaker find an audience without assuming unmanageable debt? Can technicians, performers and writers obtain sustained work? Answering these questions requires contracts, payment histories and production records that the public sources examined here do not supply. Until those records are available, reported commercial success and artistic achievement should be described precisely, without converting either into a universal verdict on the industry.

The figures describe particular transactions and reported successes. The choices ahead concern the conditions in which many different kinds of films might continue to be made.

PART 4 · MAKING THE NEXT FILM

14 Keeping the next screen open

The future of Odia cinema is better approached as a set of choices than as a forecast. One possible path is a stronger network of places to watch films: more dependable local screenings, useful showtimes and events that help audiences encounter unfamiliar work. Its success would be visible in who can attend, not merely in an announced number of buildings.

A second path is continuity of production. Public facilities and private businesses could be assessed by affordable access, reliable services and the range of productions they enable. Support could be discussed in terms of the work completed and the people paid, rather than the prestige of an inauguration. These are proposed measures, not outcomes already demonstrated.

A third path connects circulation with care. Clear rights, good subtitles, accessible versions and preservation copies could allow a film to travel and remain available after its first release. A streaming catalogue, a cinema run and a restored print need not compete to be the final form of a film's life.

None of these possibilities requires every filmmaker to pursue the same scale or audience. A popular genre film, an intimate family drama and a work rooted in a particular locality can ask different things of their viewers. The task is to create room for those differences to continue. The next chapter of this history will be written through decisions about money, labour, access and memory as surely as through the stories on the screen.

Sources and reading notes

These notes retain the sources and material limits of the reviewed chapters. Titles link to their original records; return links lead to the cited passages.

01 The world in our own voice

1. Il Cinema Ritrovato, Māyā Miriga, 2024 programme, screening date, filmmaker's note and restoration account. Return

2. Minati Singha, "Sita Bibaha prints lost", The Times of India, 29 April 2011, paragraph identifying Kamapal Mishra's play. Retrospective attribution; the original play edition was not inspected. Its missing-print report is not a current preservation survey. Return

3. Piyush Roy, The Aesthetics of Emotional Acting, University of Edinburgh PhD thesis, title page 2016, repository release 2017, printed pp.137-139 and 143-144. Goswami's performing background and Roy's 2014 interview with Surya Deo. The latter is an attributed historical reading, not a fresh viewing of the film. Return

4. Alok Baral, "Communication Through Folk Elements: A Study in Modern Odia Drama", Global Media Journal-Indian Edition 4(2), December 2013, p.3, "Exploring the Geetinatya Style." Theatre scholarship; a shared practitioner does not establish adaptation of a particular musical play. Return

5. Kapilas Bhuyan, "75 Years of Odiya Film Making: A Flashback", IFFI retrospective hosted by PIB, 22 November 2010. Opening chronology, music and literary-adaptation paragraphs. An authored retrospective, not a surviving 1936 screening programme. Return

6. Odia Bibhaba, Gopal Chhotray collection, biographical account of AIR Cuttack's 1948 opening and Chhotray's association. This dates the Cuttack institution, not the beginning of all Odia broadcasting or listening elsewhere. Return

7. Library of Congress, Gopal Chhotray: South Asian Literary Recordings Project, author profile and recording catalogue. Used for work across genres and AIR association; no numerical measure of influence inferred. Return

8. Gour-Parbati archive, Sri Jagannath (1950), film credits. "Dialogue" names Gopal Chhottray; "Director & Screenplay" names C.R. Mitra. Spelling follows each source. Return

9. Gour-Parbati filmography, compiled by Khirod Naik and Shekhar Barman. Entries distinguish production from directing and identify the collective directing credit "Siddharth." Return

10. Gour-Parbati archive, Chha Mana Atha Guntha (1986), story, direction, screenplay and cast credits. Return

11. Odisha Film Development Corporation, RTI Manual 1, incorporation date and objectives. Institutional remit is not a claim that every service operated continuously. Return

12. Mute Entertainment Private Limited / Mute Studio, India Cine Hub. Indexed full directory record inspected; direct page unavailable. Crowd-sourced listing of advertised services, not verified current capacity, quality or a documented film client. Return

13. Actor, Heartthrob, Superstar. Jyoti Prakash Sahoo, MyCityLinks, 15 July 2018; Uttam Mohanty on changing shooting conditions. Return

14. Odisha Industries Department, Activities Report 2021-22, final two pages; The New Indian Express, 26 March 2021, identifies the then chief minister. Projected spending, deadlines and jobs are not treated as outcomes. Return

15. Chief Minister's Office, Kalinga Studio inauguration, 5 October 2026. Official event record, not an independent assessment of facility use. Return

16. Nirad Mohapatra's memorial biography, teaching, Cinexstasy and appreciation-course account. Retrospective biography; no audience totals adopted. Return

17. Directorate of Film Festivals, 31st National Film Awards catalogue, Second Best Feature Film citation: films of 1983, awards in 1984. Indexed catalogue text inspected; direct PDF access was intermittent. Return

18. Semaine de la Critique, Maya Miriga, 1984, official selection record. Return

19. International Film Festival Mannheim-Heidelberg, 1984 archive, award list. The historical Third World competition category is reproduced to avoid conflation with the overall prize. Return

20. 29th National Film Awards catalogue, Best Oriya Film citation for 1981; and Indian Panorama 1985 catalogue, Manmohan Mahapatra biography naming Paris and Montreal screenings. Indexed original catalogue text; exact first Panorama-selection year is not asserted. Return

21. Ashok Palit, "The New Wave Cinema of Odisha", *E-CineIndia*, October-December 2024, pp.3-4 and 6. Used for attributed critical descriptions, not as a substitute for festival award registers. Return

22. Riyan Ramanath V, "Film highlights struggle to survive in rural Odisha", *The Times of India*, 28 November 2012, paragraphs on *Bhukha*'s play source and folk drummers. Used for those details only; the report's relative-year arithmetic is inconsistent and is not adopted. Return

23. 70th National Film Awards catalogue, printed p.036, Sabyasachi Mohapatra biography: 1989, Sambalpuri, Gijón International Jury Award. Indexed official catalogue text inspected; the original Gijón award record and exact prize year remain unverified. The research prompt included _rohitmahanand's Instagram reel; it is a discovery lead, not independent award evidence. Return

24. Directorate of Film Festivals, Indian Panorama 2014 catalogue, printed p.031, producer biography recording *Sala Budha*'s 2013 Panorama selection. Return

25. PIB, 62nd National Film Awards results, 24 March 2015, Best Odiya Film category for 2014. Language-category wording follows the award record. Return

26. Amrit Amlan Pattanaik, "Reading auteurship and subregional subjectivities in the Sambalpuri cinema of Sabyasachi Mohapatra", *Studies in South Asian Film & Media* 17(2), pp.153-172. Issue dated December 2025; publisher lists online publication on 27 March 2026. Abstract and bibliography inspected; the full article was not available in this pass. Return

27. Lok Sabha, 7 December 1987, printed pp. 99-100, CFSI production list for financial year 1985-86. Indexed parliamentary record; financial year is not an exact theatrical release date. Read source. Return

28. Arsenal Berlin, Kino in Indien catalogue, 1986, Odia-cinema overview. Historical catalogue synopsis; no priority claim or fresh full-film viewing. Odia title spelling also appears in OdishaLIVE. Read source. Return

29. 41st National Film Awards catalogue, Best Children's Film entry and synopsis p.182. Award for 1993; plot description follows catalogue. Differing producer credits are not resolved here. Odia title spelling follows Sahitya Charcha. Read source. Return

30. Central Board of Film Certification, certificates issued 2022, p.127, Return of Hanuman, 11 February 2022, certificate VIL/1/10/2022-DEL. Video certification is not the original film's release date. Read source. Return

31. Airtel Xstream, Return of Hanuman catalogue listing, checked 26 October 2026. Lists 2007, Odia, animation and children's entertainment; playback, audio, subscription and territory not tested. The displayed Odia title is an editorial

transliteration of the provider's English title; an official Odia title spelling was not verified. Listing and certification runtimes differ and are not assumed to describe the same cut. Read source. Return

32. Directorate of Film Festivals, 22nd National Film Awards catalogue, Best Actor citation for Sadhu Meher in *Ankur*, films of 1974. Indexed original citation inspected; direct PDF retrieval timed out. Return

33. Nandita Das, "I am still searching for a place to call home", *Open*, 2013. Reuses the KB source identity `creators-nandita-roots`. Return

34. Nandita Das, Acting, "Biswaprakash - The Young Rebel": 1999, director Susant Misra, language Oriya. An acting credit, not a claim that every film in her career is Odia. Return

35. Festival de Cannes, Nandita Das, official jury and film-selection history. See also the existing KB source `creators-manto-cannes` for the film's own credits. Return

36. Akashvani, Uttam Mohanty obituary, 28 February 2025, cross-language film work. Career totals and disputed birth-year arithmetic are not required here. Return

37. Minati Singha, "Legendary musician Prafulla Kar passes away in Bhubaneswar", The Times of India, 18 April 2022. Used for the reported reception of his Mamata music, not an audited box-office figure. Return

38. PIB, 69th National Film Awards results, 24 August 2023, Best Odia Film for 2021. The CBFC 2021 certification list, row 53, dates certification to 29 December 2021; this is separate from theatrical release. Return

39. PIB, 70th National Film Awards results, 16 August 2024, Best Odia Film for 2022. This is the Odia film *Daman*, not the unrelated Hindi film of 2001. Return

40. PIB, IFFI53 cast-and-crew account of Pratikshya, 23 November 2022. Synopsis, Gourahari Das story connection and Dipanwit's lead-role testimony. Festival appearance is distinct from the film's award eligibility year. Return

41. Arindam Ganguly, "Four Odia flicks to clash at box office", OrissaPOST, 8 October 2024. Pre-release account of Karma's director, lead actor and investigator role; not evidence of eventual revenue. Return

42. Express News Service, "KJo's Dharma Productions to remake 'Bou Buttu Bhuta'", 24 September 2025. Reported cast, budget, revenue and acquisition-in-progress notice. The revenue figure is not clearly specified as net/gross or by territory; no audited profitability, all-time ranking or later deal completion is asserted. The report's unrelated Pratikshya announcement chronology is not adopted. Return

43. Express News Service, "Amid cinema hall crisis, 'Raja' releases run to packed houses", 18 June 2025. Contemporary reporting and named distributor testimony; not an audience survey or a current statewide theatre census. Return

44. Two new films signal there's hope for Odia movie industry. The New Indian Express, 13 November 2022. Release geography and reported attendance; no market-level receipts. Return

45. Phalgun Chaitra to be premiered in Australia. Post News Network, OrissaPOST, 26 April 2023. An announcement of planned screenings. Return

46. "Phalguna Chaitra returns to theatres", OrissaPOST, 14 July 2023. Indexed text of the original newspaper PDF; full PDF not inspected. The report's multi-country screening claim is not an independently audited release or revenue total. Return

47. Overseas markets emerge as big opportunity for local streaming platforms as diaspora seeks more regional content. Lata Jha, Mint, 1 April 2025. AAO NXT founder's account of diaspora demand; the article's general regional-OTT percentage is not Odia-specific. Return

48. Prasar Bharati, DD Odia, official satellite-service history and programme catalogue. These dates do not mark the first television transmissions in Odisha. Return

49. Basil Kannagi Arasu, Tarang Plus launch report, OnlyTech, 4 November 2019. Launch-era offering; historical subscription terms are not presented as current. Return

50. Film Heritage Foundation, Maya Miriga restoration account and credits. Named institutions are credited collectively; individual conservators are not all identified. Return

51. District, INOX SGBL Square Mall, 25 October 2026. Date-specific public listing inspected 25 October 2026; seats not checked. Return

02 AIR Cuttack: where stories found another voice

1. Cuttack district administration, History, paragraph on 1948 and the old Madhupur building. Indexed institutional chronology; direct page returned an error during recheck. Not a contemporary inauguration record. Return

2. Jose Jacob, "A visit to AIR Cuttack & others", February-March 2008 visit account, pp.1-2. Engineer-guided observations and historical recollections; equipment descriptions are dated, not a current service inventory. Return

3. Kapilas Bhuyan, PIB/IFFI cinema retrospective, 22 November 2010, first-feature chronology. Return

4. Library of Congress, Gopal Chhotray: South Asian Literary Recordings Project, profile and recording catalogue. Author readings are distinct from AIR drama recordings. Return

5. Gour-Parbati archive, Sri Jagannath (1950), dialogue versus screenplay credits. Odia spelling is supplied for the film title; the source uses Roman script. Return

6. Odia Bibhaba, Gopal Chhotray collection, biography and catalogue. The 1974 listing dates the edition; no first-broadcast date or music credit is inferred here. Return

7. Shyamanuja Das, "In Conversation with Odia Lyricist Devdas Chhotray", Sahapedia, interview conducted September 2018, Parts II-III. Personal recollection of studio practice and his first recorded ghazal, not a claim to the first-ever Odia ghazal. Return

8. David Dennen and Amir Kumar Jeetendra Nayak, "Shyamamani Devi on Odissi Music and Her Life as a Singer", mirrored interview, opening section. Original interview date unverified; the cited passage names Akashvani but does not specify its station. It is used as wider broadcasting context, not proof of a Cuttack appointment. Return

9. Shyamanuja Das, PV Krishnamoorthy and modern Odia songs, OdishaBytes, 16 October 2020. Attributed retrospective, not a personnel record; sole-founder and comparative greatness claims are not adopted. Return

10. Akashvani News, Cuttack bulletins, inspected 25 October 2026. Dated listings establish online availability; no listening figures or full audio-archive survey claimed. Return

03 The page behind the screen

1. Fakir Mohan Senapati, Chha Mana Atha Guntha, chapter10, "Bhagia and Saria," opening paragraph, Odia Wikisource community transcription: Source . Exact quoted sentence checked26October2026 against that transcription; not collated to a historical printed edition. English rendering made for this book from the Odia; not borrowed from a published translation. "Community" carries the passage's social/caste context without erasing it. Return

2. Fakir Mohan Senapati, Rebati, opening household passage, Galpa Swalpa, Odia Wikisource: Source . Selected excerpt and surrounding paragraph checked26October2026. Community transcription, not a facsimile-collated quotation.

English rendering for this book; no author or fluent-reader approval claimed. This is a literary parallel, not an asserted source for any film discussed here. Return

3. Gour-Parbati archive, Kaa: Source . Film page identifies Kanhucharan Mohanty's novel; chronology follows the archive's1965heading, not a fresh award-year reconciliation. Return

4. Riyan Ramanath V, "Film highlights struggle to survive in rural Odisha," Times of India,28November2012: Source . Return

5. PIB, IFFI53 cast-and-crew account,23November2022: Source . Reused source for Gourahari Das story connection. Return

6. BookMyShow, Ananta film listing, "About movie." Indexed listing inspected 26 October 2026; direct access was blocked. The listing identifies Fakir Mohan Senapati's Randi Pua Ananta as its source; no full-film comparison is asserted here. Return

04 Parbati Ghose: the woman behind the credits

1. Gour-Parbati archive, Chha Mana Atha Guntha (1986), production, screenplay, cast and technical credits. Return

2. Gour-Parbati archive, Filmography, entries for Laxmi, Kaa and Stree. Collective credits are retained rather than recast as solo direction. Return

3. Peter Samuels, "Teaching about the Colonial India State and Society with Six Acres and a Third", Education About Asia, 10 June 2020. Used for the novel's conflict; no claim of scene-by-scene fidelity in the film adaptation. Return

4. Gour-Parbati archive, Awards. Used for the films' recognition, not an individual acting-award claim. Return

05 Sadhu Meher: acting, directing and crossing languages

1. Directorate of Film Festivals, 22nd National Film Awards catalogue, Best Actor citation and Sadhu Meher biography. Official indexed text was available; direct PDF access was intermittent. Return

2. ShemarooMe, Ankur: The Seedling, official cast-role synopsis. The plot account above follows published synopses, not a fresh full-film viewing. Return

3. Kapilas Bhuyan, "75 Years of Odiya Film Making: A Flashback", PIB/IFFI, 22 November 2010. Audience-response claim attributed to the author. Return

4. Actor, Heartthrob, Superstar. Jyoti Prakash Sahoo, MyCityLinks, 15 July 2018; Uttam Mohanty's recollection. Return

5. 60th National Film Awards catalogue, printed p. 043, South I jury biography; contemporary career count, not a lifetime census. Return

06 Manmohan Mahapatra: households under pressure

1. Directorate of Film Festivals, Indian Panorama 1985 catalogue, Klanta Aparanha entry and director biography. Indexed synopsis and credits; direct PDF unavailable. The production date is not an established release date. No fresh viewing claimed. Return

2. Ashok Palit, "The New Wave Cinema of Odisha", E-CineIndia, October-December 2024, pp. 3-4. Critical framing attributed to Palit; no fresh full-film viewing claimed. Return

3. 29th National Film Awards catalogue, Best Oriya Film, films of 1981; award recognition in 1982. Return

4. Exit of a cinematic giant. Bijay Mandal, OrissaPOST, 28 January 2020; named colleagues' recollections. Return

07 Maya Miriga: a family and a second life

1. Museum of Modern Art, Māyā Miriga, To Save and Project, screenings on 10 and 15 January 2025. Used for the programme description and restoration credits; no film still reproduced. Return

2. Il Cinema Ritrovato, Māyā Miriga, 2024 programme, 27 June screening. Return

3. Cannes Critics' Week, Maya Miriga, 1984. Return

4. International Film Festival Mannheim-Heidelberg, 1984 archive. Return

5. Directorate of Film Festivals, 31st National Film Awards catalogue, Second Best Feature Film. Return

6. Antti Alanen, Māyā Miriga / The Mirage (2024 restoration), Film Diary, 27 June 2024. The official-film synopsis reproduced on the page identifies Prabha's family

relationship; his separate “AA” response supplies the critical assessment. The latter is one critic’s view, not an audience survey. Return

08 Bhukha: a tradition must also feed a family

1. Ashok Palit, “The New Wave Cinema of Odisha”, E-CineIndia, October-December 2024, discussion of Bhukha. Return

2. Riyan Ramanath V, “Film highlights struggle to survive in rural Odisha”, The Times of India, 28 November 2012. Used for the play and performers’ livelihood, not its relative chronology or “first” claim. Return

3. Sambalpuri sonority. OrissaPOST, 2 August 2015; music credit and forms, not a reception survey. Return

4. OdishaPlus, “Tete-e-tete with Sabyasachi Mohapatra”, July 2022. Director’s retrospective testimony on reception and distribution; no independently audited revenue claim. Article draws on published accounts, not a fresh full-film viewing. Return

5. 70th National Film Awards catalogue, Sabyasachi Mohapatra biography, printed p. 036. Original festival award register remains to be checked. Return

6. Amrit Amlan Pattanaik, “Reading auteurship and subregional subjectivities in the Sambalpuri cinema of Sabyasachi Mohapatra”, publisher abstract; issue dated December 2025, online publication March 2026. Return

7. Press Information Bureau, 62nd National Film Awards results, 24 March 2015. Return

09 Nandita Das: roots and routes

1. Nandita Das, “I am still searching for a place to call home”, Open, 8 August 2013. First-person account of birthplace, upbringing and Baripada visits. Return

2. Nandita Das, Acting, “Biswaprakash - The Young Rebel”; Directorate of Film Festivals, 47th National Film Awards catalogue, Biswaprakash cast entry and Best Feature Film in Oriya citation, printed p. 72. Award for films of 1999; cast and award evidence are not an individual acting-prize claim. Return

3. Festival de Cannes, Nandita Das, jury attendance and Manto selection. Jury membership and selection are distinguished from awards. Return

4. Festival de Cannes, Manto: official synopsis and credits, 2018. Synopsis-based discussion rather than fresh scene-level viewing. The existing Manto and Zwigato KB records retain the research trail. Return

5. Nandita Das Initiatives, Zwigato: story and director's note, setting, languages and 2022 festival premieres. These are festival premiere dates, not a theatrical release date. Return

10 DAMaN: a doctor, a journey and the people around him

1. Cinema Express, interview with Vishal Mourya, 7 December 2022. Documentary assignment, collective inspiration and casting are the director's account. Return

2. Press Information Bureau, 70th National Film Awards results, 16 August 2024, Best Odia Film. This is a film-category award, not a National Best Actor award for Babushaan. Return

3. 70th National Film Awards catalogue, printed p. 082, DAMaN synopsis and credits. The story's 2015 setting is not the programme's launch date. Synopsis-based discussion; no fresh full-film viewing claimed. Return

4. Film Information, review of the Hindi-dubbed DAMaN, 3 February 2023. Used for character casting, release and an attributed critical assessment, not as audited revenue evidence. Return

5. Indulge, interview with Babushaan Mohanty, 14 February 2023. Actor's account of preparation and ambitions; the report dates the original opening to 4 November 2022. Return

6. Atri Prasad Rout, "DAMaN, a spark in the dark", OrissaPOST, updated 13 December 2022. His review praises the film's craft while identifying a risk in its single-protagonist structure. Audience and commercial claims elsewhere in the review are not adopted here. Return

7. Pradyumna Behera, "Doctorhood, Mosquitos and the Adivasis", Countercurrents, 23 December 2022. An attributed critical argument about representation, not a community survey or resident testimony. Its wider historical and medical assertions are not independently established by this citation. Return

8. Odisha Health and Family Welfare Department, Annual Activity Report 2022-23, printed p. 41 (PDF p. 49). Historical programme data, not current medical guidance or evidence of the film's health impact. Return

9. Danielle C. Ompad et al., "The effectiveness of malaria camps as part of the malaria control program in Odisha, India", Scientific Reports 13, 22998 (2023), Results and Discussion. Non-random assignment and pandemic disruption limit inference. Authors include programme personnel. The Introduction dates programme implementation to 2017, distinct from the film's 2015 setting. The evaluation followed camps in 15 villages in Keonjhar and Jharsuguda during 2019-20, comparing early- and delayed-camp groups. Return

10. Madan Mohan Pradhan et al., "Community Healthcare Providers' Perspective on Malaria Control in Difficult Terrains (DAMaN) in Odisha, India", Journal of Communicable Diseases 57(1), 55-64 (2025), Methods and Themes 2-3. Qualitative interviews, not an outcome evaluation or film-reception survey; programme staff participated in the research. No direct Malkangiri resident response to the film was established in this research pass. Return

11. Aishwarya Mohanty, "Miles to go: In these tribal regions of Odisha, the nearest health clinic is jungles & rivers away", Down To Earth, 14 April 2023, opening Sanuguda account. The source changes the resident's name. Report supported by the HSTP Health Journalism Fellowship 2022; one reported account, not a programme evaluation or film-reception survey. It does not establish present-day conditions. Return

11 Odia television: stories that return

1. ZEE5, Kemiti Kahibi Kaha, programme synopsis, cast and episode catalogue, inspected 25 October 2026. Platform descriptions establish the listed offering, not independent reception or revenue. Return

2. Prasar Bharati, Annual Report 2010-11, printed p.118, DD Bhubneshwar history. Dates distinguish production facilities, transmission and later satellite service. Return

3. Mrinal Chatterjee, Television in Odisha, Odisha State Open University hosted historical resource, pp.1-4. Its ETV dates differ between text and table; only the early-2000s period is used here. Historical account, not a present-day market census. Return

4. Prasar Bharati, DD Odia, institutional history and linked programme catalogue, inspected 25 October 2026. Current channel history distinguishes the 1993 service from the 1994 name change. Catalogue links are not evidence of original broadcast dates or a claim of full programme viewing. Return

5. Exit of a cinematic giant. Bijay Mandal, OrissaPOST, 28 January 2020; retrospective work list. Return

6. Odisha Television Network, institutional history, inspected 25 October 2026. Owner's account of 1997 cable beginnings and 2006 satellite conversion; promotional leadership claims omitted. Return

7. ZEE, 2015-16 annual report financial notes, note 35, printed p.130. Acquisition effective 4 December 2015. Return

8. IDMT, Utkal Cartoon World catalogue. Producer claims; priority and feature-release status not independently established. Read source Return

9. The New Indian Express, "Ganesha comes alive through animation." URL dated 2010; displayed update 2012. Report of planned broadcasting, not independently checked transmission log. Read source Return

10. ELE Animations, "Pogo's new show Jay Jagannath celebrates friendship," 8 May 2024. Announcement lists Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Marathi and Malayalam. Read source Return

11. Film Information, Mahaprabhu Jagannath review, 4 September 2026. Release/credits used; critical verdict not presented as consensus. Read source Return

12. ELE Animations public company feed, indexed 26 October 2026. Language publicity retained; earlier announced dates do not supersede later dated release reporting. Read source Return

13. ELE Animations, Toonz partnership announcement, 18 February 2023. Announced rights arrangement, not evidence of realised earnings. Read source Return

14. Fakira Mohan Nahak, Live Broadcast, Rath Yatra and ETV, OdishaPlus, 24 February 2022. Participant recollection; engineer Akshay Mohanty is not identified as composer Akshaya Mohanty. Legal and "first" claims are not adopted. Return

15. Jyoti Prakash Sahoo, From Spotlight to Struggles, MyCityLinks, 8 January 2025. Named interviews; unsupported audience ratios and medical causation claims are not adopted. Return

12 Odia OTT: stories beyond the broadcast hour

1. Basil Kannagi Arasu, Tarang Plus launch report, OnlyTech, 4 November 2019. Reports the 27 October launch and launch-era offering; prices and "first" claims are not adopted. Return

2. Jyoti Prakash Sahoo, Tarang Plus and Chumbak, MyCityLinks, 4 March 2020. Named maker and actor interviews; no independent audience survey or full-series

viewing is claimed. The interviews concern making the series, not a survey of audience reception. Return

3. Choudhury Rajeshwari, Interview with Kaushik Das, Media Infoline, 15 February 2023. Founder's chronology and operational account; announced future releases, "first" claims and subscriber totals are not treated as audited outcomes. Return

4. Individual creator can challenge large organisations, says Rath, OrissaPOST, 21 March 2025. Co-founder's account of the platform and its catalogue; not an independent ranking or revenue audit. Return

5. AAO NXT's Four anthology. Madhushree Chakrabarty, Media Infoline, 15 December 2022; one critic's response, not audience measurement or evidence of a particular subtitle arrangement. Return

6. Tata Play, Binge adds regional OTT services including Tarang Plus, 12 January 2023. Corporate distribution announcement; historical package terms are not a current subscription guide. Return

7. Lata Jha, Overseas markets emerge as big opportunity for local streaming platforms, Mint, 1 April 2025. AAO NXT founder's diaspora comments; broader regional-platform percentages cannot be assigned to Odia cinema. Return

8. Kanccha Lannka, Apple App Store, developer description inspected 25 October 2026. English subtitles advertised for selected titles; catalogue description, not playback or territorial-availability testing. Return

13 What Makes the Next Film Possible

1. The New Indian Express, "Maya Miriga is Nirad's gift to Odia cinema,"22 September 2024. Reports Sabita Mohanty's festival recollection of a Rs 4 lakh NFDC loan; the total production budget is not supplied. Read source. Return

2. The Federal, report on Bou Buttu Bhuta,30 June 2025 (updated1 July). Reports a Rs 2-3 crore production budget and almost Rs 12 crore boxoffice after 17 days; no audited settlement or producer share is supplied. Read source. Return

3. Odisha Film Development Corporation, RTI Manual 1, institutional objectives. Stated purposes do not establish individual disbursements or current access. Read source. Return

4. Chief Minister of Odisha, Kalinga Studio and cinema archive/museum inauguration announcement,5 October 2026. The announcement does not measure bookings or outcomes. Read source. Return

5. India Cine Hub, Mute Entertainment Private Limited / Mute Studio, Bhubaneswar, directory listing. Advertised services, not independently inspected capacity. Read source. Return

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The book gathers eleven reviewed essays and three book-only chapters into four parts. The preface, connecting passages and additional reflective chapters were prepared for this edition. Source articles and original image files remain unchanged. No fresh full-film viewing, comprehensive audience survey or definitive filmography is claimed.

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